



WINDOWS RELEASE 4.0.0

# Ether 4.0 User Manual

Build, run, review, and deliver local-first creative work from one portable `.ether` document.

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PRODUCT

ETHER by DreamBay

EDITION

4.0.0 release manual

CAPTURE SOURCE

Installed packaged  
application

## RELEASE EVIDENCE

Every application image in this manual comes from Ether 4.0.0 installed through the reviewed Windows installer under a disposable profile. The capture manifest records SHA-256 hashes for the installer, executable, fixture, and each image.

Installer SHA-256: `f30bf31701c644ec59f321bacd3edff52a90cbf1e2eb6b353e235f6980f5a5f5`

## Version 4.0.0 | Windows | DreamBay

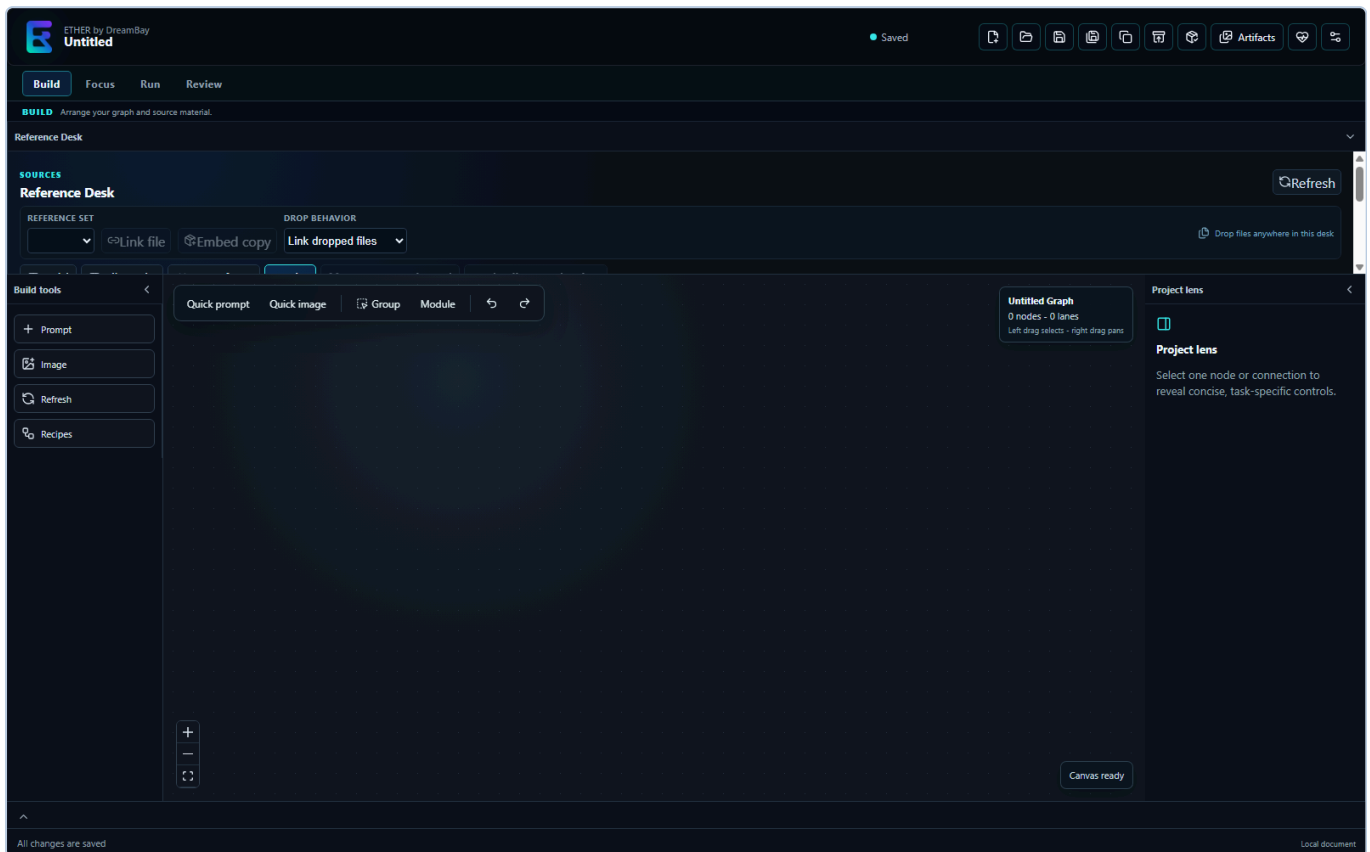
Ether is a local-first creative production canvas. An Ether project is one portable `.ether` document containing its graphs, revisions, embedded media, runs, collections, and review decisions. It is designed around a simple visible model: a **node** does work, a **channel** carries a kind of payload, and a **role** tells the receiving node how to use it.

Release-candidate images are inserted only by `docs/manual/capture-release.mjs`, which launches the installed Ether executable under a disposable Windows profile. This source manual deliberately contains no substitute development-renderer captures.

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# Start safely



Packaged Ether release capture - Start screen on a clean profile

Choose **New document** to start an untitled usable canvas, or **Open document** to select one supported `.ether` file. Press `Ctrl+S` to name a new document. After a name exists, Save flushes pending work and creates a manual milestone; it does not create a project folder.

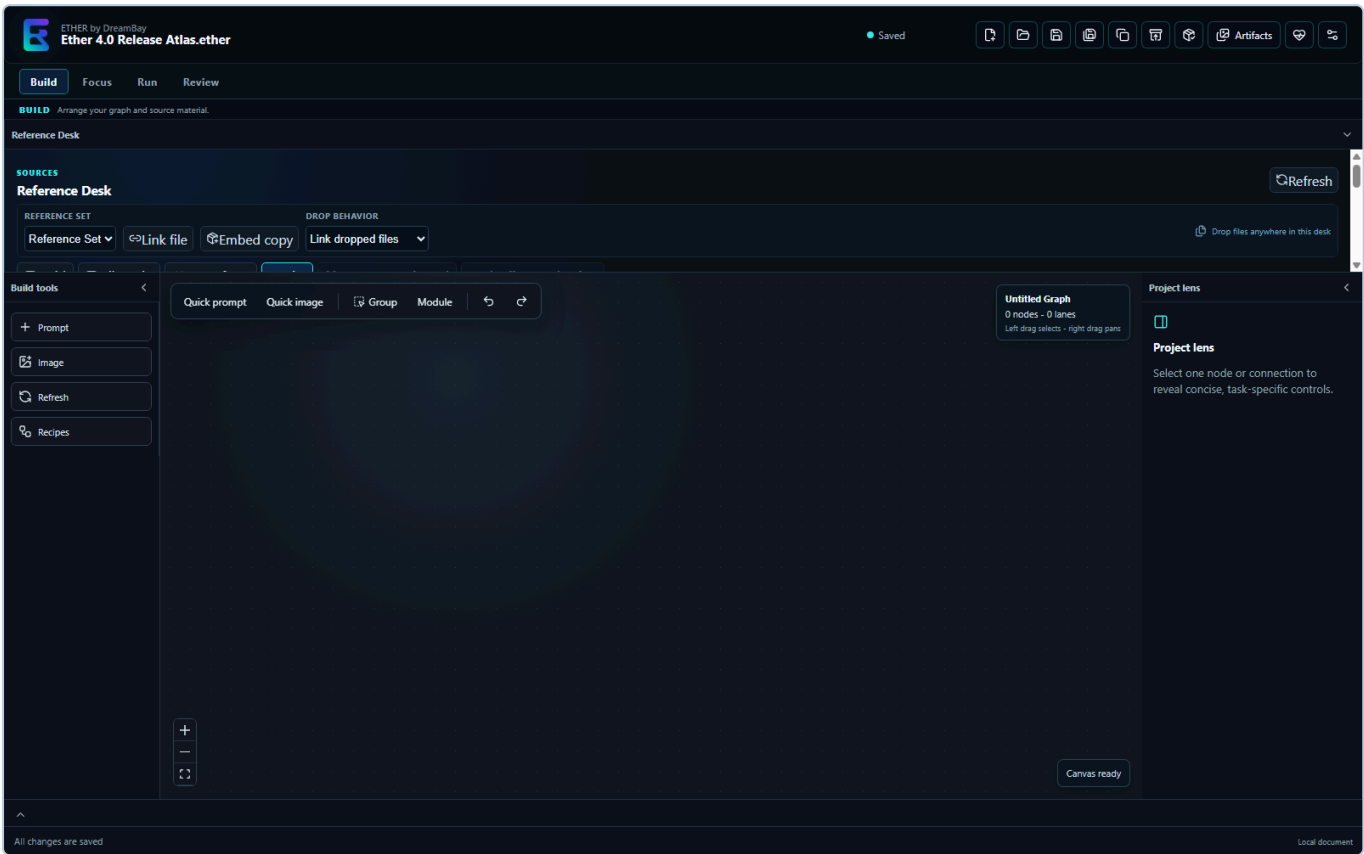
Ether opens maximized so the canvas and its supporting panes use the available desktop. The standard Windows title-bar controls remain available to minimize, restore, resize, or close the app.

Ether 4.0 does **not** open, import, or migrate legacy Ether folder projects. A directory containing `project.json`, `graph.json`, or `ether.db` is refused unchanged. Create a new `.ether` document and bring in only the source media you need.

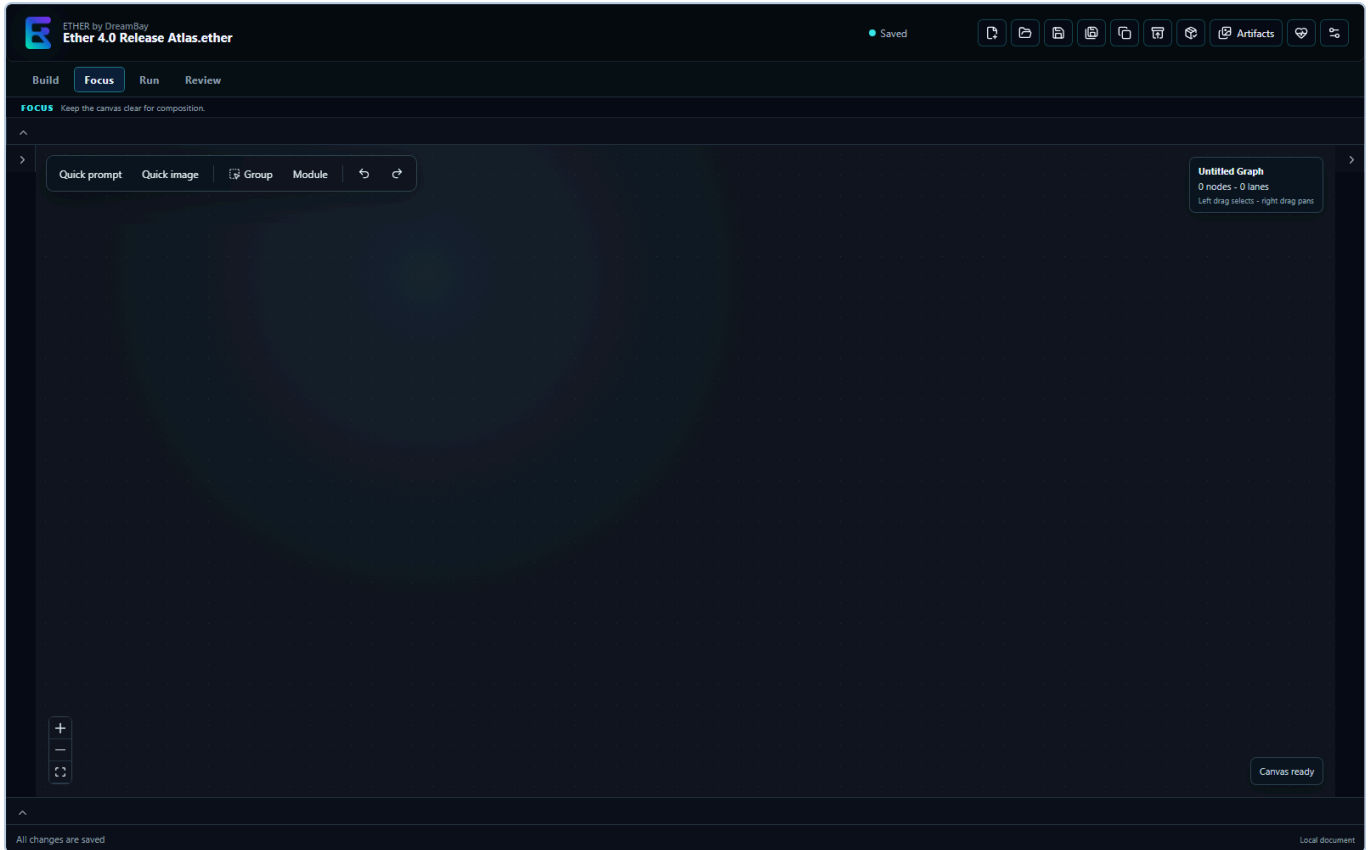
The installed runtime retains its dependency license files and a `THIRD-PARTY-NOTICES.txt` native-library notice. It does not ship benchmark, fixture, specification, source-map, cache, or development-configuration material.

The title bar reports **Saving**, **Saved**, or **Needs attention**. Idle edits autosave after 1.5 seconds and are not deferred longer than ten seconds. `File > Save As` validates a new destination and switches to it only after success. `Save a Copy` validates a copy but leaves the original active. `Compact Document` reclaims abandoned embedded-object pages and reports the actual before/after size.

# Workspaces



Packaged Ether release capture - Build workspace with the release atlas

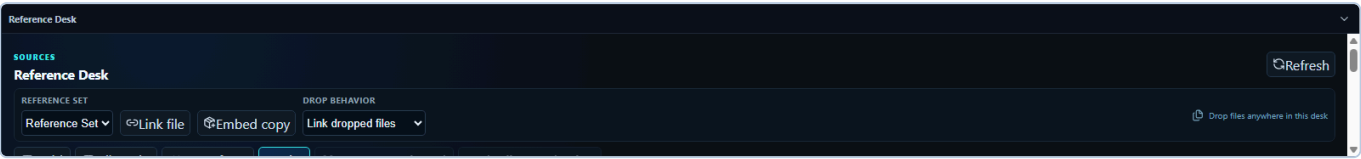


Packaged Ether release capture - Focus workspace

| Workspace     | Use it for                                   | Primary surfaces                                                     |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Build</b>  | Constructing and wiring workflows            | Node Library, canvas, Inspector, compact Job Center                  |
| <b>Focus</b>  | Editing one selection with less visual noise | canvas, selected node/module, optional Reference Desk                |
| <b>Run</b>    | Previewing scope and operating durable work  | immutable plan, Job Center, Batch Matrix, live output strip          |
| <b>Review</b> | Choosing and delivering results              | Artifact Observatory, Compare, Evaluate, Filter, collections, export |

Use the workspace switcher at the top. Left, right, top, and bottom panes have their own collapse and resize controls; their layout is retained per workspace and document. The canvas receives spare window space. The minimap remains adjacent to the Inspector rather than behind it. At narrow widths, labels give way to icon buttons with tooltips instead of vertical text.

# Documents, references, and recovery



Packaged Ether release capture - Reference Desk with an embedded reference



Packaged Ether release capture - Production recovery status

## References

Drop supported image, video, audio, or text material onto the document and organize it in **Reference Desk**. Drops are linked by default; choose **Embed dropped files** when portability matters. Dropping onto a Reference Set adds assets rather than silently replacing them. In the Reference Set Inspector, enter reference IDs and choose **Add references** or **Replace set** explicitly. Reference Desk supports grid, comparison, role overrides, include/exclude selection, assignment to sets, and a target Batch dimension.

Linked items retain their identity, path, timestamps, size, fingerprint, and an embedded preview. If a link goes missing, it remains visible. Use **Locate**, **Search Folder**, **Relink All**, **Use Embedded Preview**, **Embed Available Copy**, or **Remove**; do not assume a preview is a recovered original. **Make Document Portable** shows the expected size change, missing items, and embeds every available linked source after confirmation.

## Read-only, recovery, and repair

Only one process may hold a writable lease. If another writer or an unsuitable cloud/network location has the document, open it read-only where supported. Read-only mode disables changes but preserves inspection and export paths that are safe for the document state.

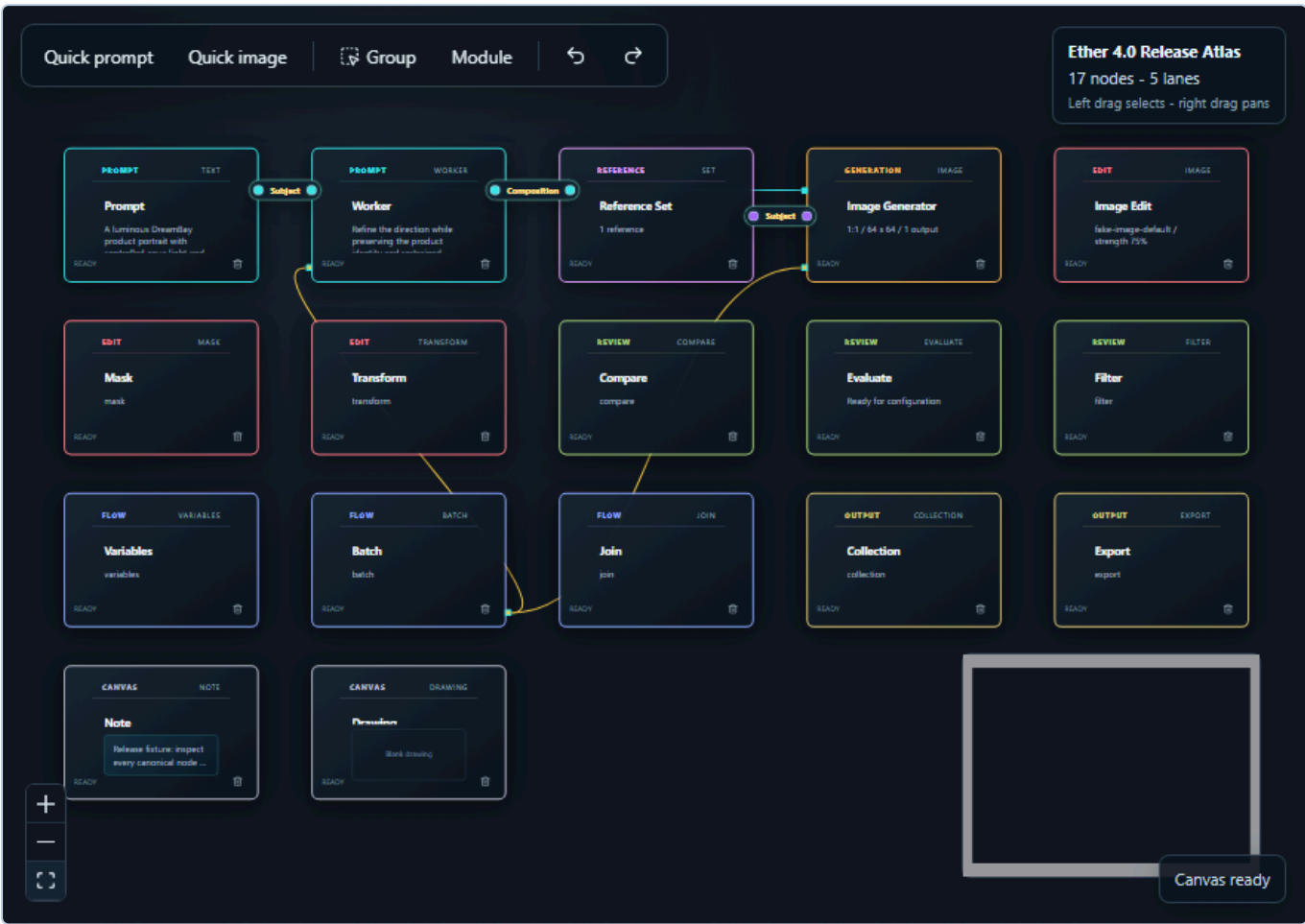
Interrupted imports and provider staging are recorded in Ether-owned AppData, never beside the document. On the next open, recovery is shown as a reviewable revision rather than silently merged. Damaged metadata may open in read-only recovery. Repair writes a **new** `.ether` file and a report; it never mutates the damaged source. See [Troubleshooting](#) for the recovery decision tree.

**Recovery decision flow.** Text alternative: Start with the open result. A healthy document continues in writable mode. A writer or location restriction opens read-only. Interrupted work goes to recovery review. Damaged metadata stays unchanged while Repair writes a new document.

```
Open .ether
|
+-- Healthy -----> Writable document
|
+-- Writer/location restriction -----> Read-only -> close writer or save a safe copy
|
+-- Interrupted work -----> Recovery review -> keep or dismiss revision
|
+-- Damaged metadata -----> Read-only recovery -> Repair to a new .ether
```

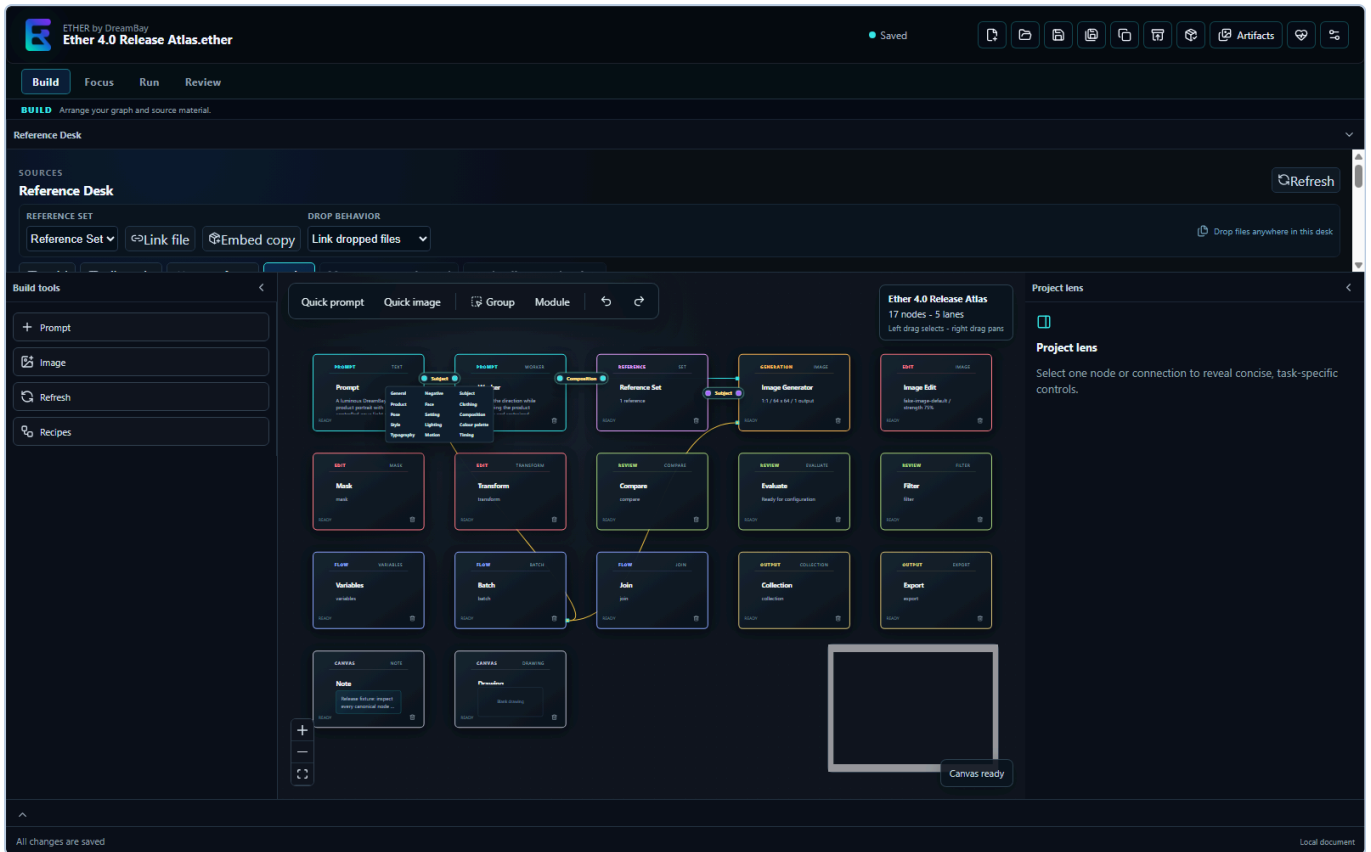
| Open result                                   | -> Review                                   | -> Safe action                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Healthy document                              | Saved state and document header             | Continue in writable mode                                     |
| Writer active or location restricted          | Read-only reason                            | Close the other writer or save a copy to a safe local drive   |
| Interrupted import, save, or provider staging | Recovery revision and reconciliation report | Keep or dismiss the recovered revision after inspection       |
| Damaged metadata                              | Read-only recovery and repair report        | Repair to a new <code>.ether</code> file; preserve the source |

# Canvas, nodes, connections, and Inspector



Packaged Ether release capture - Canvas containing all 17 canonical nodes





Packaged Ether release capture - Channel lane and role chooser

Select a node or lane to open the contextual Inspector. Empty-canvas click clears selection; left-drag selects, right-drag pans, and selected nodes move as a group. Undo/redo applies graph transactions, including changes from recipes and the plugin. A Group is visual organization only; a Module is a collapsible subgraph with declared inputs, outputs, and exposed parameters.

Each node has an editable **Title**, but its canonical kind is fixed. The card shows connected ports at rest, status when queued/running/blocked/failed/recently done, and one primary action only if the node can actually perform one. **Advanced** disclosures hold diagnostics, provenance, and expert controls. A Prompt deliberately has no Run button.

## Channels and roles

Channels use both a shape and color. A valid lane carries one channel and one role. Ether rejects an exact duplicate lane but permits distinct lanes between the same pair when channel, role, or selector differs.

**Node, channel, and role flow.** Text alternative: Prompt sends Text with the Subject role to Worker. Worker sends approved Text with the Composition role to Image Generator. Reference Set sends Image with the Style role to the same Image Generator. The generator stores an immutable Image output for Review.

```
Prompt ----- Text / Subject -----> LLM Worker
LLM Worker -- Text / Composition -----> Image Generator ---- Image ----> Review
Reference Set --- Image / Style -----/
```

| Producer node | -> Channel | -> Role at receiver | -> Receiver node | -> Result                  |
|---------------|------------|---------------------|------------------|----------------------------|
| Prompt        | Text       | Subject             | LLM Worker       | A versioned refined prompt |

| Producer node   | -> Channel            | -> Role at receiver | -> Receiver node | -> Result                       |
|-----------------|-----------------------|---------------------|------------------|---------------------------------|
| LLM Worker      | Text, Latest approved | Composition         | Image Generator  | Positive generation direction   |
| Reference Set   | Image, All variants   | Style               | Image Generator  | Ordered visual references       |
| Image Generator | Image                 | General             | Review           | Immutable artifact with lineage |

| Channel | Payload                            | Typical use                              |
|---------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Text    | authored or generated text         | prompts, constraints, instructions       |
| Image   | still media                        | source, style, subject, generated art    |
| Mask    | editable selection geometry/raster | Image Edit guidance                      |
| Data    | structured values                  | variables, scores, metadata, routes      |
| Video   | moving media                       | references, captioning, frame extraction |
| Audio   | sound media                        | references, transcription                |

| Role       | Receiving meaning | Role     | Receiving meaning       | Role           | Receiving meaning |
|------------|-------------------|----------|-------------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| General    | default context   | Negative | excluded constraint     | Subject        | main subject      |
| Product    | item/product      | Face     | face identity           | Clothing       | wardrobe          |
| Pose       | body/action       | Setting  | environment             | Composition    | framing/layout    |
| Style      | visual treatment  | Lighting | light direction/quality | Colour Palette | color guidance    |
| Typography | type treatment    | Motion   | movement                | Timing         | time/rhythm       |

Click a lane role badge or select the lane. The Inspector offers **Role** and **Output selection: Latest approved, Latest output, or All variants**. Once an output exists you can also pin a specific version to an outgoing lane. Two direct Subject lanes become Subject and Subject 2; a Prompt -> Worker -> Worker chain remains one Subject lineage. Text/Negative enters negative constraints, not the positive prompt.

Allowed cross-channel work is always visible: Image -> Text uses Codex vision; Audio/Video -> Text requires a verified transcription or interpretation capability; Video -> Image extracts a real frame; Media -> Data yields technical metadata (semantic metadata needs Codex); Text/Data and Mask/Data have explicit parsing/serialization adapters. Unsupported connections are blocked with an explanation. Text -> Image belongs on Image Generator, not a hidden edge adapter.

## Canonical nodes and controls

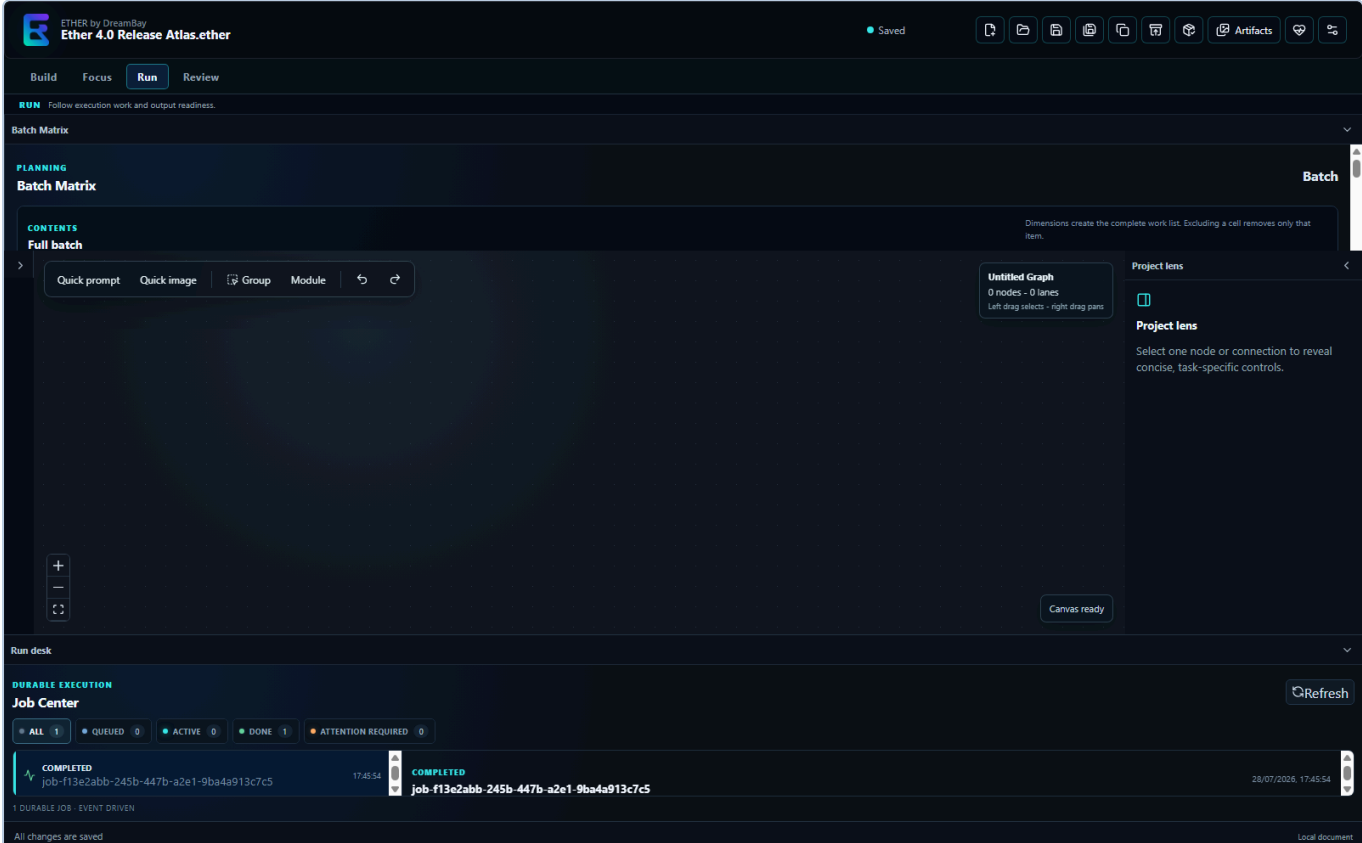
All 17 canonical nodes appear in Node Library. The **Setup** section (Title, canonical kind, Save title) is shared. Registry settings save only when valid. The following table lists ordinary controls, then Advanced controls where implemented; provider choices are populated only by verified capabilities.

| Node                                                        | Ordinary Inspector controls                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Advanced / action                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Prompt</b> ( <code>prompt.text</code> )                  | Authored text or Manual override text; Assembly: Append incoming context / Manual override; Use assembled text as manual override; Save prompt; assembled read-only text and provenance                                                                                                                | no provider action; Diagnostics & provenance                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>LLM Worker</b><br>( <code>prompt.worker</code> )         | Instruction; Behavior: brainstorm, rewrite, mutate, expand, reinforce, extract, critique, custom; AI profile: fast, balanced, deep, custom; Save worker                                                                                                                                                | Model, Reasoning effort, Variation; <b>Generate Output</b> / Preview plan; immutable output tools                                                                              |
| <b>Reference Set</b><br>( <code>reference.set</code> )      | reference IDs; <b>Add references</b> ; <b>Replace set</b> ; member count and the current order readout                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Diagnostics. Reference Desk supplies Grid, Filmstrip, Waveform, and List views plus <b>Compare selected</b> ; the Inspector does not expose channel or ordering editors in 4.0 |
| <b>Image Generator</b><br>( <code>generation.image</code> ) | Model profile; capability-derived Aspect ratio, Resolution, Output count; Reset profile defaults; Save provider settings                                                                                                                                                                               | capability provenance/limitations; <b>Generate Image</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                        |
| <b>Image Edit</b><br>( <code>edit.image</code> )            | Model profile, Output count, source image; recipe selector: Freeform edit, Product clean-up, Object removal, Outpaint scene; frame mode and X/Y/Width/Height; mask <b>Brush, Eraser, Undo, Redo, Clear</b> , Size, Opacity, and <b>Commit mask</b> ; <b>Save edit setup</b> and Save provider settings | capability provenance/limitations; local saved mask precedence; <b>Generate Edit</b> / Preview plan                                                                            |
| <b>Mask</b> ( <code>edit.mask</code> )                      | validated Mode text, Feather number, Save mask                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Run Mask</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Image Transform</b><br>( <code>edit.transform</code> )   | validated Operation text, Preserve aspect ratio; Width and Height appear only when those optional values already exist; Save transform                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Run Transform</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Compare</b><br>( <code>review.compare</code> )           | validated Selection mode text, Minimum selections; Save compare                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | human checkpoint; no hidden AI call                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Evaluate</b><br>( <code>review.evaluate</code> )         | Instruction, configured-rubric count, AI profile text, Model; Save evaluate                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>Evaluate Outputs</b> / Preview plan; Diagnostics. No separate reasoning control is exposed in this Inspector                                                                |
| <b>Filter</b> ( <code>review.filter</code> )                | validated Match text plus configured-rule and route counts; Save filter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>Run Filter</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Variables</b><br>( <code>flow.variables</code> )         | configured-variable count; Save variables                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Run Node</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Batch</b> ( <code>flow.batch</code> )                    | configured-dimension and exclusion counts, Parallelism; Save batch                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Build Batch</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Join</b> ( <code>flow.join</code> )                      | validated Strategy text, Require complete; Save join                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>Run Join</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Collection</b><br>( <code>output.collection</code> )     | Collection ID, validated Membership mode text, Make primary; Save collection                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Update Collection</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Export</b><br>( <code>output.export</code> )             | Path grant ID, Naming template, validated Format and Collision policy text, Include metadata; Save export                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Export Outputs</b> / Preview plan                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Note</b> ( <code>canvas.note</code> )                    | Body, validated Style text; Save note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | non-runnable; use for annotations                                                                                                                                              |

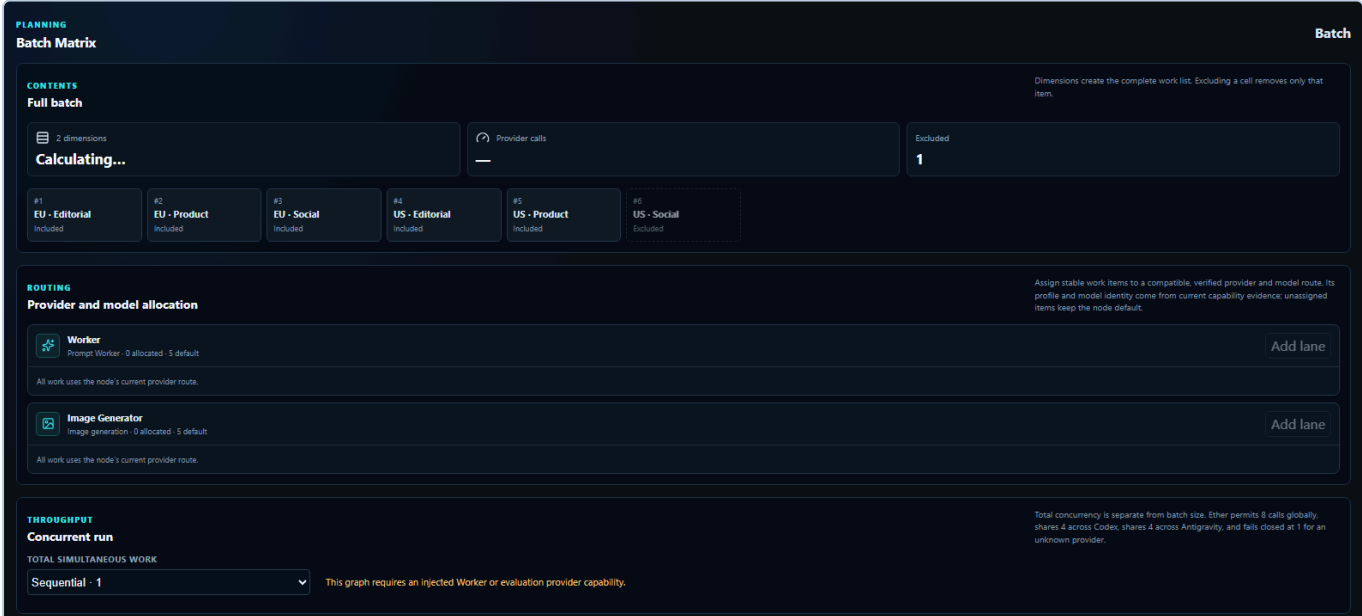
| Node                                              | Ordinary Inspector controls                                                                                                                                                                                      | Advanced / action                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Drawing</b><br>( <code>canvas.drawing</code> ) | Width, Height, Background, configured-stroke count; canvas <b>Brush</b> , <b>Eraser</b> , <b>Undo</b> , <b>Redo</b> , Brush color, Brush size, and Brush opacity; saved drawing gestures; <b>Publish drawing</b> | produces an immutable Image artifact; Diagnostics |

Runnable node Inspectors show **Preview plan** beside their available primary action. Non-runnable Prompt and Note nodes do not. Output versions remain immutable: **Approve**, **Reject**, **Edit** (creates a manual descendant), **Compare**, and **Restore** never overwrite the original. When a manual descendant or outgoing lane is available, its corresponding editor or **Pin** lane control appears conditionally. The shared Advanced **Diagnostics & provenance** section shows node ID, definition ID, and graph ID.

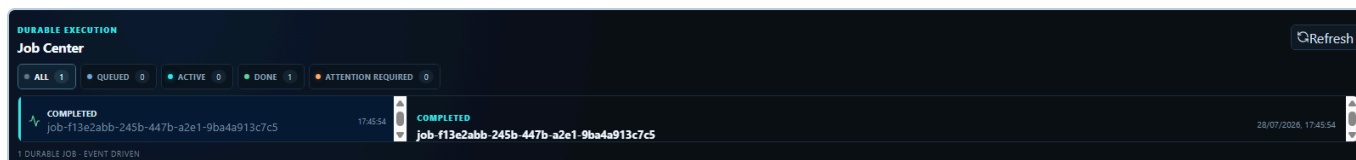
The generic 4.0 Inspector renders booleans as checkboxes, numbers as number fields, strings as validated text fields, and arrays as configured-item counts. A field named "mode," "strategy," "format," or "style" is therefore not necessarily a preset dropdown. Prompt assembly, Worker behavior/profile, provider profile/ratio/resolution/output count, and Image Edit recipes are true selectors. Worker **Variation** is intentionally kept with Model and Reasoning effort in the collapsed Advanced section in the shipped 4.0 UI; this differs from one "ordinary controls" sentence in the design prose but not from the release acceptance contract.



## Packaged Ether release capture - Run workspace



## Packaged Ether release capture - Batch Matrix with a five-item work set and separated concurrency controls



Packaged Ether release capture - Job Center with durable run evidence

**Preview plan** compiles the exact immutable plan that Run will use. Read provider, requested profile, dimensions, reference count, work-item count, estimated calls, adapters, warnings, and selected output versions before confirmation. Ether refuses execution if the plan content hash changes.

Execution policies are precise:

- **Generate Output** runs one LLM Worker from selected/cached upstream versions.
- **Generate Image / Generate Edit** runs one selected provider node from selected/cached inputs.
- **Run Selected** runs selected runnable nodes in dependency order; outside dependencies stay pinned unless Preview says otherwise.
- **Run Branch** runs the downstream scope from a node or module.
- **Refresh Upstream** deliberately re-runs stale dependencies before a target.
- **Run Recipe** follows its declared scope and checkpoints.

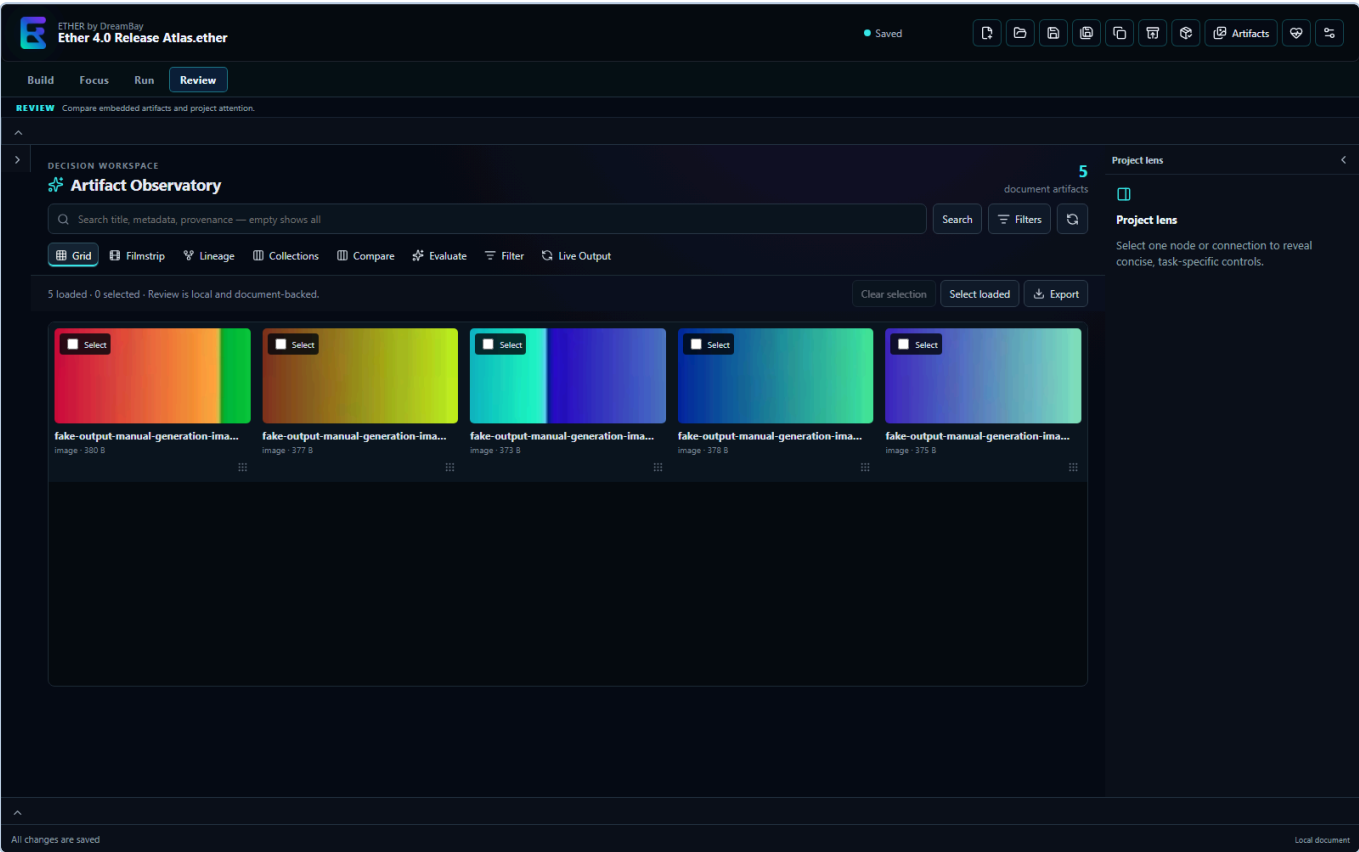
Job Center groups queued, active, completed, blocked, and failed jobs. Open a job for its timeline, work items, attempts, correlation/provenance details, and error action. **Cancel** marks queued work cancelled and asks an active provider to interrupt when supported. **Retry** creates a new attempt for failed work under the same work item and preserves the failed attempt. Ether recovers interrupted queued work when you reopen the document. Terminal jobs do not show a misleading Resume button.

**Batch Matrix** separates planning into three sections:

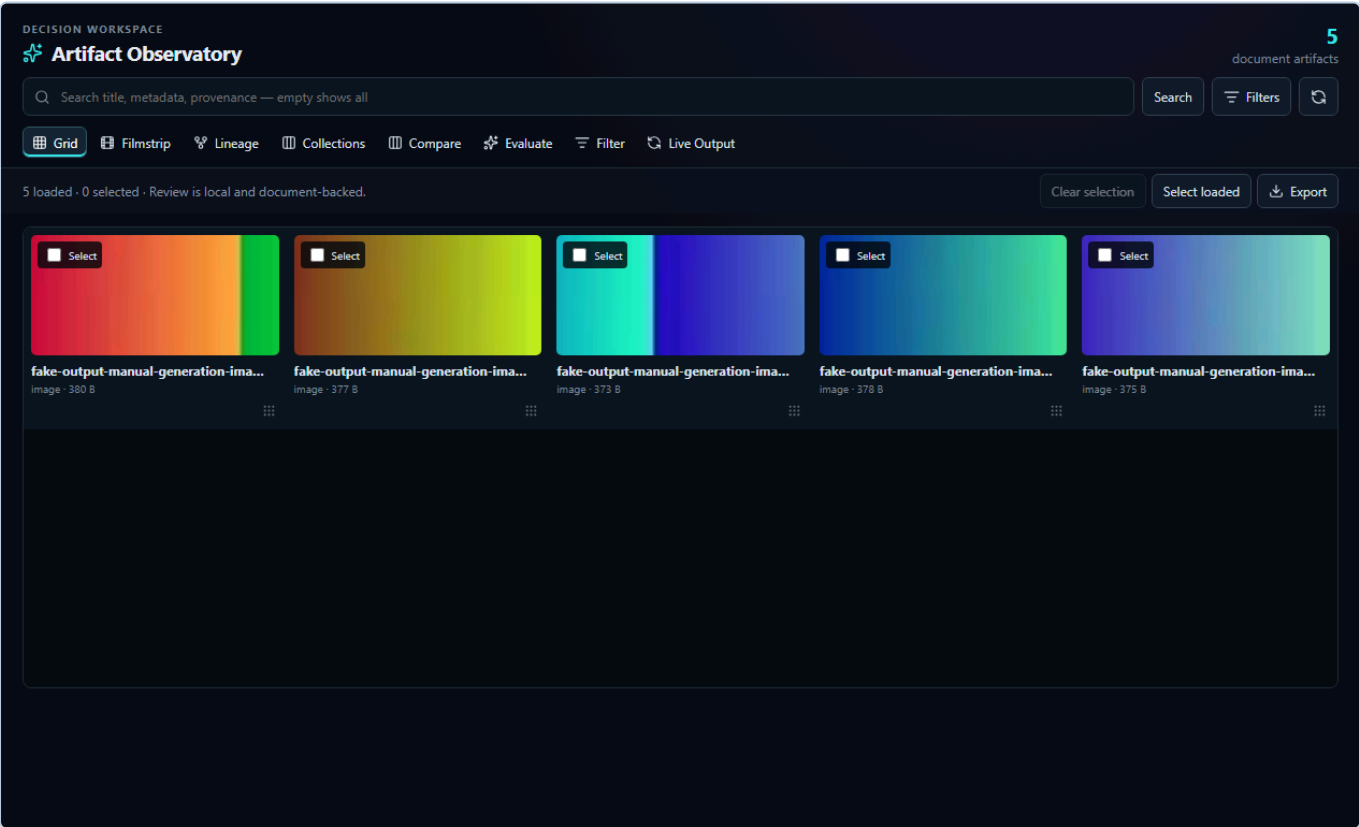
- **Full batch** lists dimensions, exclusions, exact work-item count, and estimated provider calls. Select a cell to exclude that item.
- **Provider and model allocation** finds reachable Prompt Workers and Image Generators. For a batch with **M** work items, each lane assigns an exact **N** items to a verified provider, profile, and model. Ether keeps those ordinal assignments stable; unassigned items use the target node's current default.
- **Concurrent run** controls simultaneous work independently from batch size. Sequential (**1**) remains the default. Ether uses one shared limit across the running application: 8 active calls globally, 4 Codex calls across App Server and explicit executable fallback work, and 4 Antigravity calls across verified profiles. A fifth Codex or Antigravity call and ninth global call wait. Unknown providers remain at 1. If a Codex or Antigravity route cannot support four active calls, Ether reports it unavailable instead of silently selecting a serial route.

Ether adds each batch item's dimension names and values to the effective Prompt Worker or Image Generator prompt. Exact allocation lanes retain their selected provider, profile, model, and count; Ether does not substitute another image provider. Preview the plan to inspect requested and effective concurrency before you run it. Independent batches share the same limits, and cancellation, retry, or recovery does not create extra capacity.

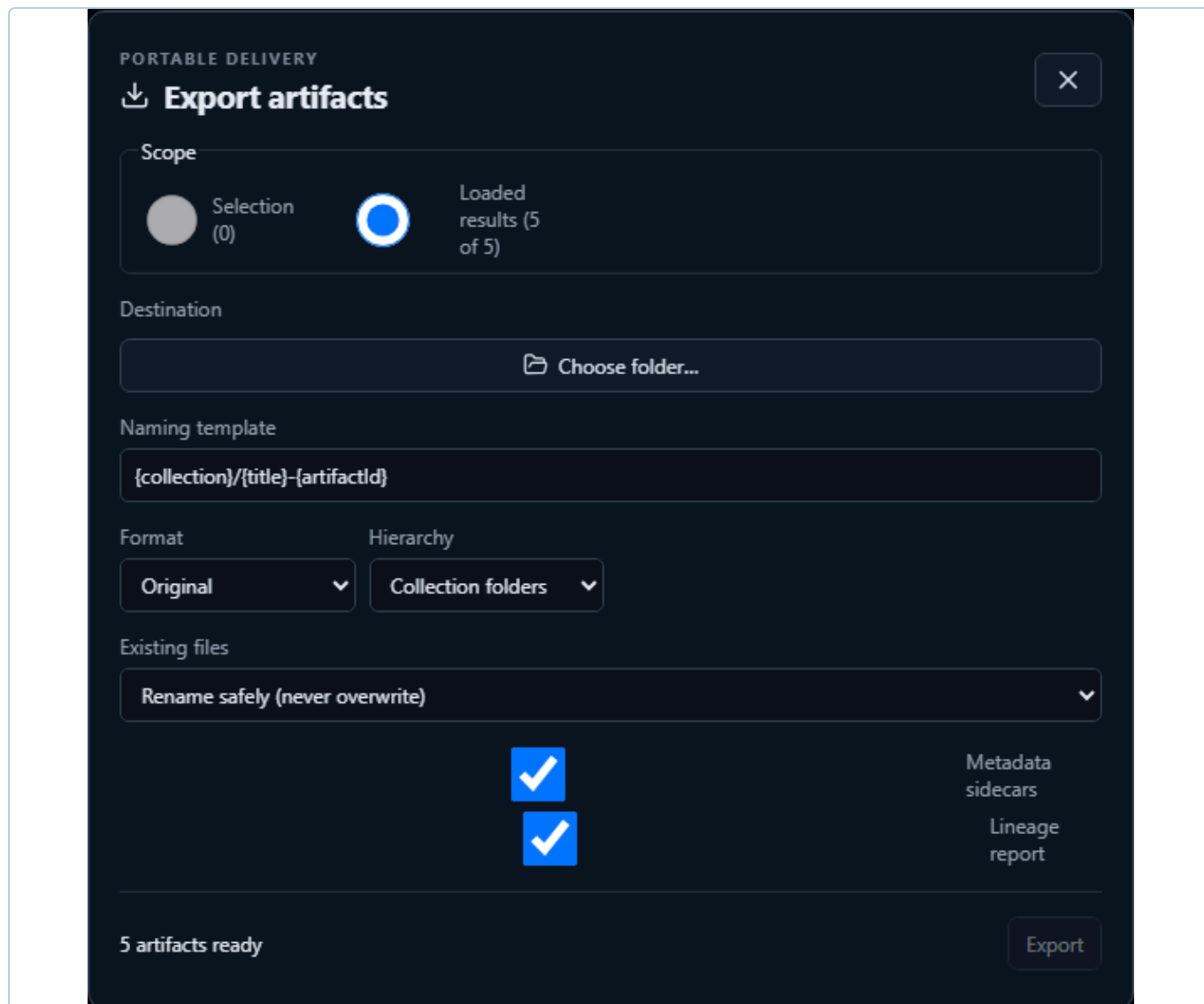
# Review, collections, and export



Packaged Ether release capture - Review workspace



Packaged Ether release capture - Artifact Observatory



Packaged Ether release capture - Artifact export dialog

In Review, **Artifact Observatory** provides virtualized **Grid**, **Filmstrip**, **Lineage**, and **Collections** views. Empty search means all document artifacts. Filters cover channels, collections, tags, rating, provider, model, run, graph, output version, and dates. Select artifacts for batch actions or open details for provenance, tags, ratings, and recorded evaluation.

**Compare** is a human checkpoint: choose candidates, add notes, and complete the decision. It does not call Codex. **Evaluate** sends the visible instruction and rubric to Codex, previews the compiled request, and stores structured criteria, scores, explanations, and model provenance. **Filter** deterministically routes items using visible rules; every result explains the matching or nonmatching rule.

Collections are many-to-many and non-destructive. Create one, route selected artifacts, or mark a collection primary; membership never moves the authoritative embedded artifact. **Export Selected** and **Bulk Export** use an explicit folder grant. Set naming, output format, hierarchy, collision handling, metadata sidecars, and lineage reports in the export dialog.

**Live Output** is an optional disposable mirror and starts **Disabled**. Select a mirror folder, choose naming (artifact title, node title, or stored template), transfer (copy/move), and collision behavior before enabling it. While enabled, use **Reconcile**, **Rebuild mirror**, **Disable**, or **Remove mirror files**. Removing a mirror never removes embedded originals.



# Providers and intelligent work

LOCAL RUNTIME EVIDENCE

Provider Health

Ether reports only routes and capabilities observed by this installed application. It never invents a fallback.

RUNTIME

Unavailable

TRANSPORT

unavailable

VERIFIED PROFILES

0

CHECKED

17:46:36

APPLICATION-OWNED RUNTIME

codex-chatgpt-image-2

Version

0.144.2

Process phase

none

Manifest evidence

579e6d66fe30749682

Restart count

0

Codex App Server reported an unrecognized version; Ether requires 0.144.2.

CONFORMANCE EVIDENCE

Capability profiles

No verified provider profile is available. Generation controls remain unavailable instead of guessing.

DOCUMENT PROVIDER REPORT

UNAVAILABLE

codex-chatgpt-image-2

Codex App Server reported an unrecognized version; Ether requires 0.144.2.

No telemetry leaves this machine. Health checks inspect local process and conformance evidence.

Check again

Packaged Ether release capture - Provider Health with installed runtime evidence

The Provider section of Image Generator and Image Edit is populated only from discovered, verified capabilities. If none is available, the Inspector says that Ether will not guess settings and leaves the operation unavailable. A released Provider Health surface must report the detected runtime/authentication state and its capability evidence; if that surface or a profile is unavailable, do not infer that the provider can run. Enabled controls never guess a ratio, resolution, output count, reference limit, edit mode, or cancellation feature. A version or executable-hash change invalidates stale evidence until a new conformance probe passes.

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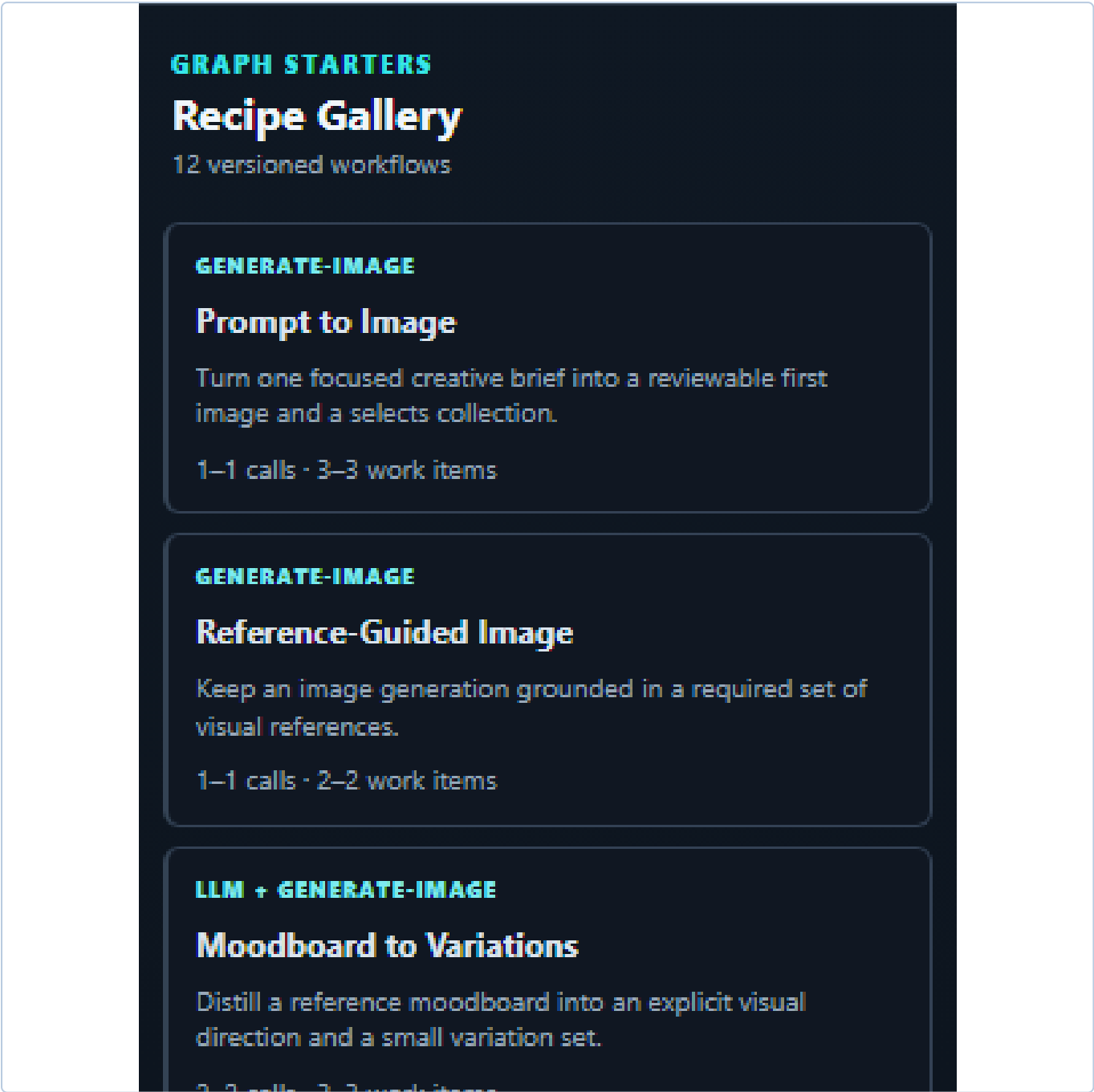
| Route              | What Ether uses                                                                                              | Honest unavailable state                                                                                      |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Codex LLM</b>   | Codex App Server where available; visible <code>codex exec</code> fallback when App Server cannot initialize | Worker, Evaluate, and semantic adapters remain unavailable if no authenticated supported Codex runtime exists |
| <b>Codex Image</b> | installed authenticated Codex subscription route with version-pinned image conformance                       | no inferred image capability and no hidden paid API fallback                                                  |
| <b>Antigravity</b> | official <code>agy.exe</code> , isolated per-attempt staging, verified requested profile                     | disabled until executable/authentication/conformance are valid                                                |

Antigravity profiles are **Nano Banana 2**, **Nano Banana Pro**, and **Nano Banana 2 Lite**. All three passed the Ether 4.0 release probe against Antigravity CLI 1.1.7. Its image tool accepts aspect ratio but has no resolution parameter. Real 2K and 4K requests on Nano Banana 2 and Pro still returned 1K files, so Ether offers only the exact conformed 1K pixel size for each verified ratio. It never labels that output 2K or 4K. Lite is also restricted to verified 1K output. Changing ratio selects the matching verified pixel dimensions automatically. Ether reuses the machine's persisted Antigravity session silently; an ordinary image run does not open a browser or authentication window. Ether records the requested profile independently from provider-reported identity. A changed CLI version or executable hash disables stale capabilities until a new probe passes. Authentication, capability, invalid input, timeout, cancellation, process, and malformed-output failures are distinct. No subscription CLI operation silently becomes a paid API call.

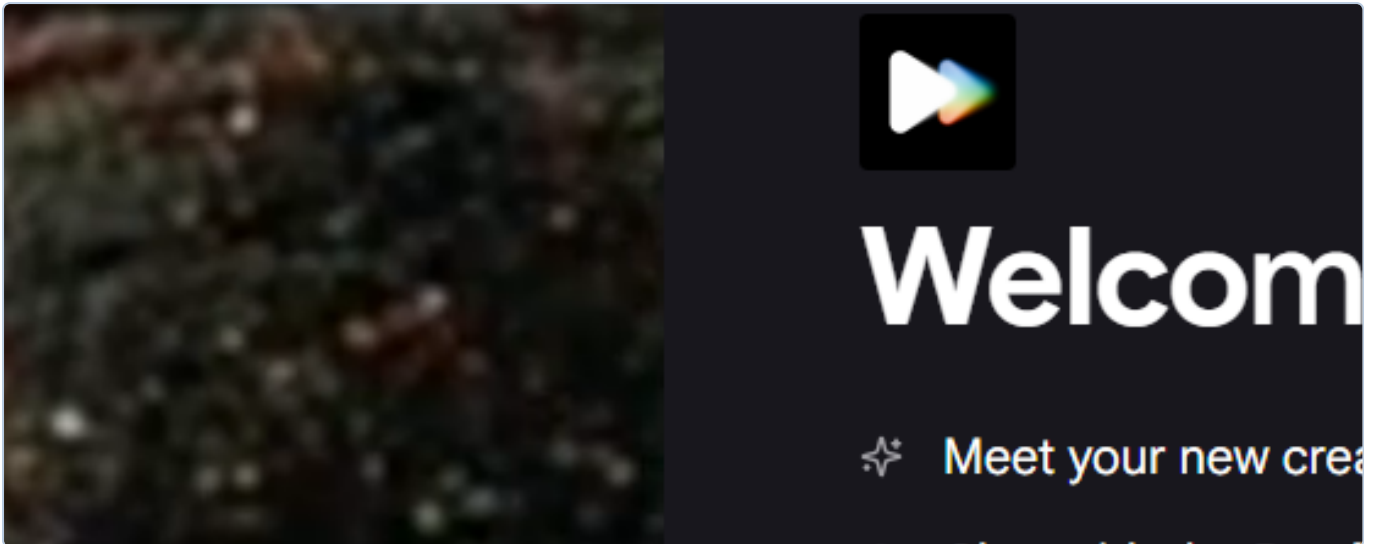
Open **Settings > Antigravity safety** after you set the official Antigravity **AI Credit Overages** option to **Never**. Check **I confirmed AI Credit Overages is set to Never in Antigravity** to save that confirmation. Ether disables every Antigravity route while the box is unchecked. Checking it permits only CLI profiles that also pass the installed runtime, authentication, version, and conformance checks. Ether cannot change the Google billing setting for you.

For a Worker, ordinary controls are instruction, behavior, and AI profile. Fast, Balanced, Deep, and Custom resolve to inspectable settings. Advanced contains the actual model, reasoning effort, and variation. Worker output is a new output version; it never rewrites a Prompt or another worker's instruction. Image/audio/video context is sent only if the selected Codex model and adapter capability support it.

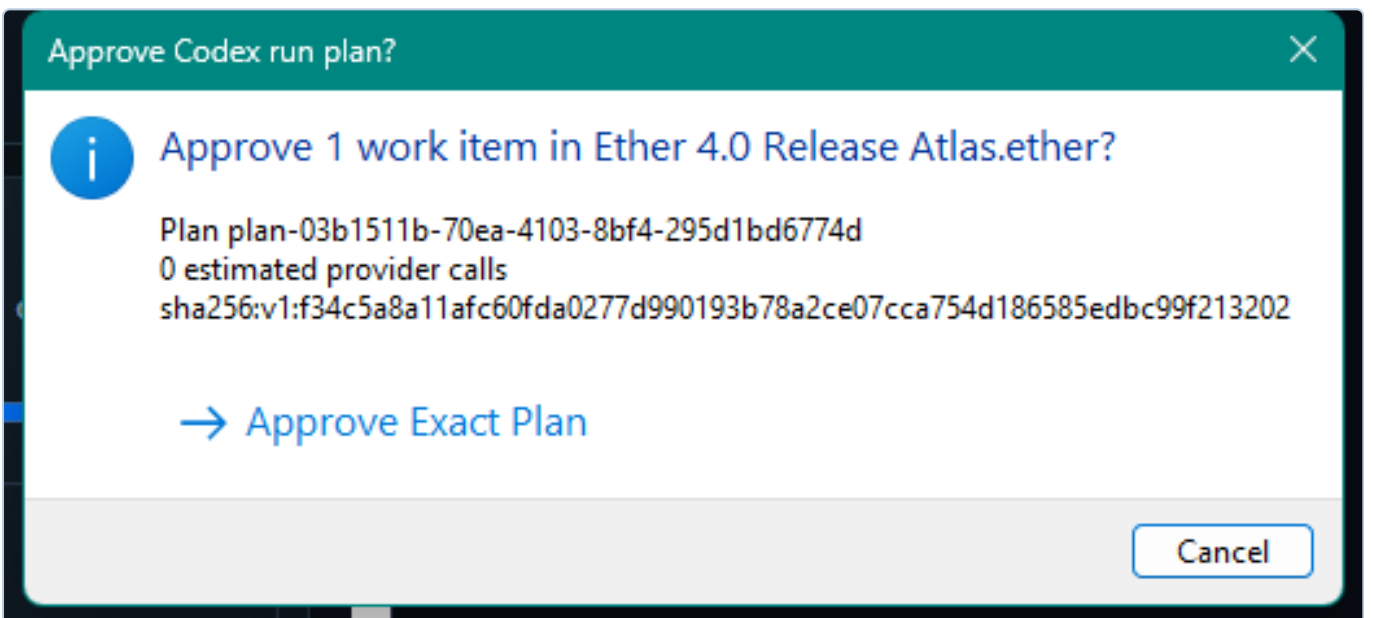
# Recipes and Codex plugin



Packaged Ether release capture - Recipe Gallery



Packaged Ether release capture - Native Edit Permit confirmation



Packaged Ether release capture - Native exact-plan Run Permit confirmation

Recipes are versioned, executable blueprints. Insert one from the recipe gallery, complete its setup sheet, inspect required capabilities, expected calls/work items, substitutions, and checkpoints, then apply the preview. Insertion is one undoable graph transaction. The 12 included recipes are:

1. Prompt to Image
2. Reference-Guided Image
3. Moodboard to Variations
4. Draft with Lite, Finish with Pro
5. Character Consistency Sheet
6. Product Campaign Set
7. Infographic Builder
8. Image Edit with Mask
9. Reference Description to Prompt
10. Batch Variations and Contact Sheet

11. Evaluate and Route

12. Curate, Collect, and Export

If a required provider is unavailable, the setup sheet offers only a declared supported substitution or blocks honestly. The resulting graph/module remains titled, connected, inspectable, and undoable.

The Ether Codex plugin is an external co-producer, not a second in-app chat. It can inspect document health, catalog and capabilities; inspect/validate a graph; preview/apply a transaction; list/instantiate recipes; inspect artifacts, references, and runs; preview immutable plans; start/cancel/retry only with permission; and inspect recovery.

| Permit             | Allows                                                                    | Never allows                                      |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Inspect</b>     | read document/graph/capabilities/health                                   | mutate graph or execute providers                 |
| <b>Edit Permit</b> | apply a previewed graph transaction within its temporary document scope   | start a provider or grant itself Run permission   |
| <b>Run Permit</b>  | start one exact immutable plan ID and content hash after desktop approval | a changed plan, broad execution, or self-approval |

Use the desktop menu to grant an Edit Permit or approve the exact latest Codex plan. A base-revision conflict returns rebaseable information. The plugin can create prompts, workers, references, generation, review, collections, and export preparation in one transaction, then inspect and repair the graph it created.

# Settings, accessibility, and privacy

INSTALLED APPLICATION

Settings

These preferences affect this local Ether interface only. Project content remains inside the active ".ether" document.

Interface

Readable, persistent renderer preferences.

Control density

Comfortable

Interface motion

Follow Windows

Workspace layout

Pane sizes are stored locally per document.

Build, Focus, Run, and Review keep independent pane positions. Reset removes only Ether renderer layout keys.

Reset panel layouts

Privacy & diagnostics

Release protections are fixed, not cosmetic toggles.

Telemetry

Off in Ether 4.0

Diagnostics

Local, bounded, rotating JSONL

Redaction

Credentials, user paths, and personal identifiers

Documents

Never stored in renderer preferences

Recovery

The active document's production recovery report.

State

healthy

Report

No report required

About Ether

One release identity across the app, document writer, diagnostics, and installer.

Ether

4.0.0

Electron

43.1.1

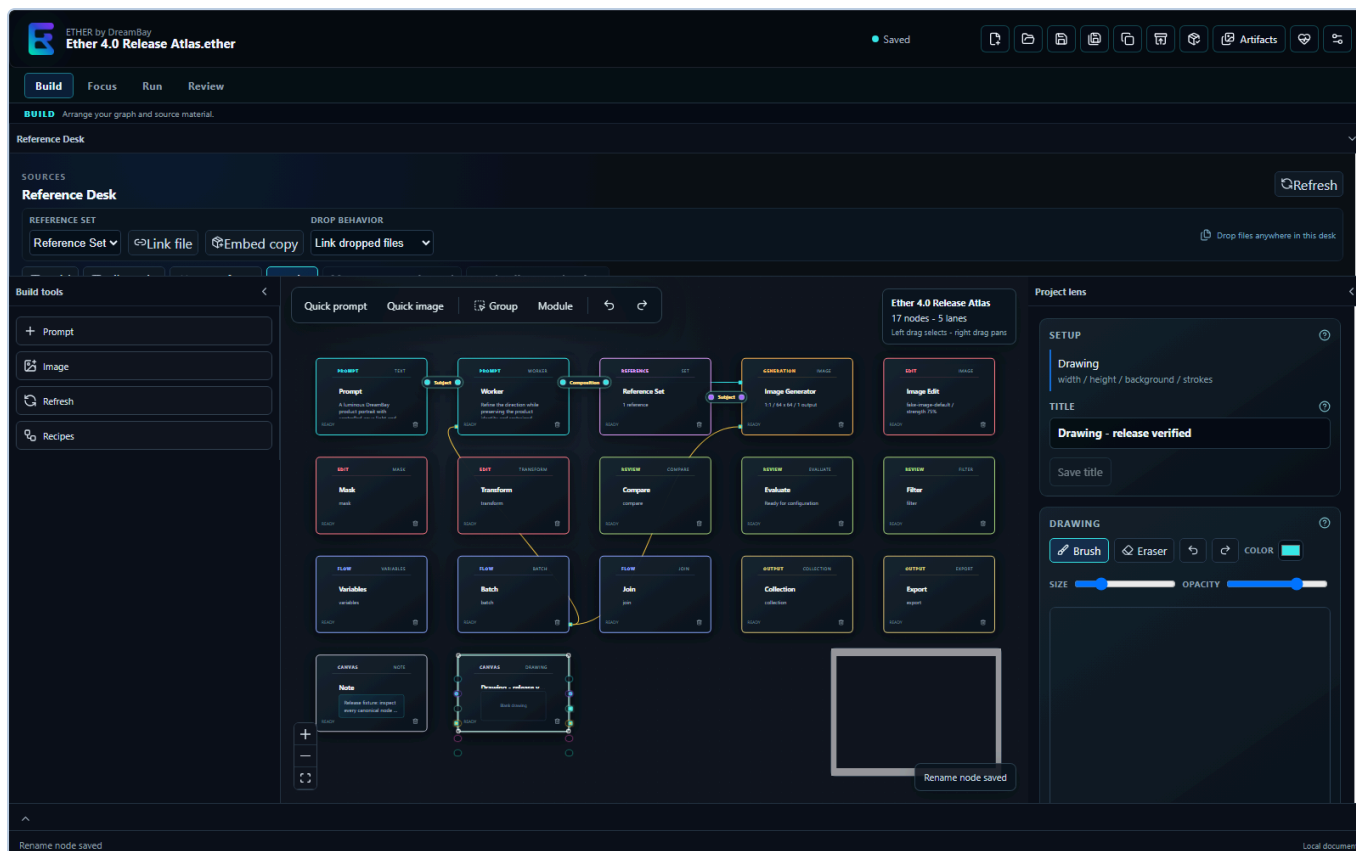
Local-first: renderer settings contain presentation preferences, never unrestricted paths or provider credentials.

Done

Packaged Ether release capture - Settings with fail-closed Antigravity safety

ETHER by DreamBay - User Manual 4.0.0

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Packaged Ether release capture - Document saving state

Settings and Provider Health expose capability, diagnostics, recent-document, local layout, and the persisted Antigravity overage confirmation without granting the renderer unrestricted file or shell access. Folder choices create scoped grants. Media is delivered through authorized `ether-asset://` document/artifact URLs; arbitrary local paths are not rendered.

Keyboard users can reach document commands, workspace switcher, canvas selection, node/channel controls, Inspector, and Job Center in normal focus order. Use the canvas toolbar for Quick prompt, Quick image, Group, Module, Undo, and Redo. Channel shape is never color-only. Tooltips explain icon commands, nodes, provider limits, policies, presets, and advanced controls. Respect Windows scaling at 100%, 125%, 150%, and 200%; reduced-motion settings remove nonessential pulsing/interpolation.

Ether is local-first. Documents, generated artifacts, embedded references, and run evidence stay on the machine. AppData holds only Ether-managed recovery, staging, cache, temporary drag-export, and log material. Logs are bounded/redacted; no telemetry leaves the computer in 4.0. Deleting caches or a Live Output mirror cannot delete document contents.

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# Examples

## Create a reference-guided campaign image

1. Create or open a document; add a Reference Set and Image Generator, or insert **Reference-Guided Image**.
2. Drop source images in Reference Desk, set each relevant role (for example Subject, Style, Colour Palette), and Add them to the set.
3. Connect Text/Subject and Image/Style or Image/Subject lanes to Image Generator. Select the output policy on each lane.
4. In Image Generator, select a verified profile, then only its offered ratio, resolution, and output count.
5. Preview plan. Check provider, references, estimated calls, warnings, and scope. Run in Run workspace.
6. Compare results, approve the chosen output, route it to a Collection, then Export Selected.

## Turn a brief into a controlled prompt

1. Add Prompt and LLM Worker. Write the source brief in Prompt.
2. Connect Prompt Text to Worker with Subject. Set Worker behavior to Rewrite, Expand, or Custom and select an AI profile.
3. Preview plan and choose Generate Output. Inspect the immutable version, then Approve, Edit (to create a descendant), or Pin it to a downstream lane.
4. Connect that output to Image Generator. A Negative Text lane remains a negative constraint, never merged into the positive body.

## Batch, evaluate, and deliver

1. Insert **Batch Variations and Contact Sheet** or add Batch and Image Generator. Define dimensions and check the exact work count in **Full batch**.
2. In **Provider and model allocation**, assign exact item counts to reachable Worker or Image Generator lanes. Leave the remainder on each node's default provider and model.
3. In **Concurrent run**, keep sequential execution or select up to eight total calls. Ether applies the lower Codex, Antigravity, or unknown-provider cap and injects each item's dimension values into its effective prompt.
4. Use Job Center to cancel eligible work or retry failed items without accepting duplicates. Ether recovers interrupted queued work when the document reopens; terminal jobs have no Resume action.
5. In Review, use Evaluate with a visible rubric, Filter with rules that explain every route, then add accepted artifacts to a collection and bulk export.



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# Reference index

**A:** Advanced controls; Antigravity; Artifact Observatory; autosave.

**B:** Batch Matrix; Build; Bulk Export.

**C:** channels; collections; Compare; Compact Document; connections; Codex; corruption.

**D:** Data channel; document; Drawing.

**E:** Edit; Embed; Ether document; Evaluate; execution policies; Export.

**F:** Filter; Focus.

**G:** Generate; graph; Group.

**I:** Image; Inspector; immutable output.

**J:** Job Center.

**L:** legacy folder projects; Live Output.

**M:** Make Document Portable; Mask; modules.

**N:** Note.

**O:** output selectors.

**P:** permits; plugin; Prompt; provider health.

**R:** read-only; recovery; Reference Desk; roles; Run.

**S:** Save As; Save a Copy; selectors; settings.

**T:** troubleshooting.

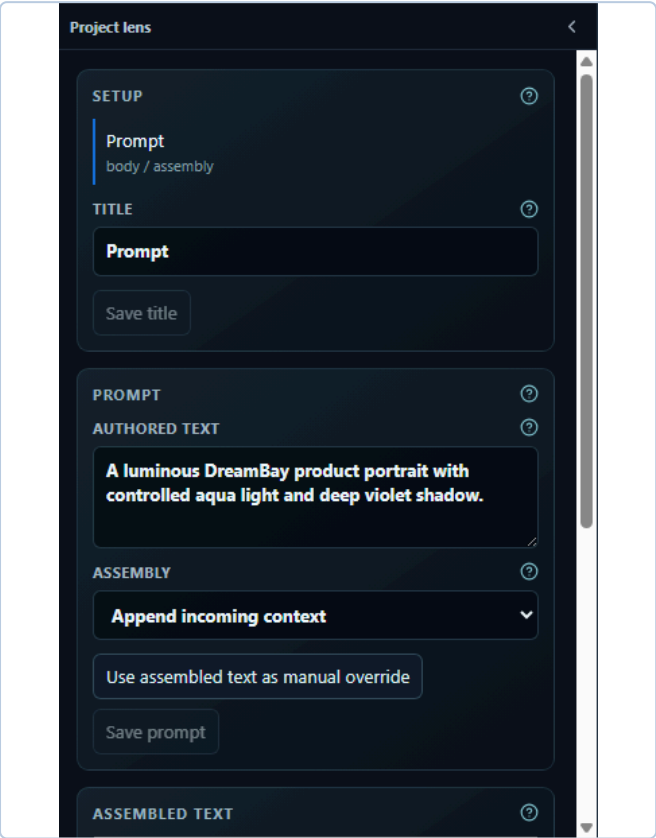
**V:** Video; variables.

**W:** Worker; workspaces.

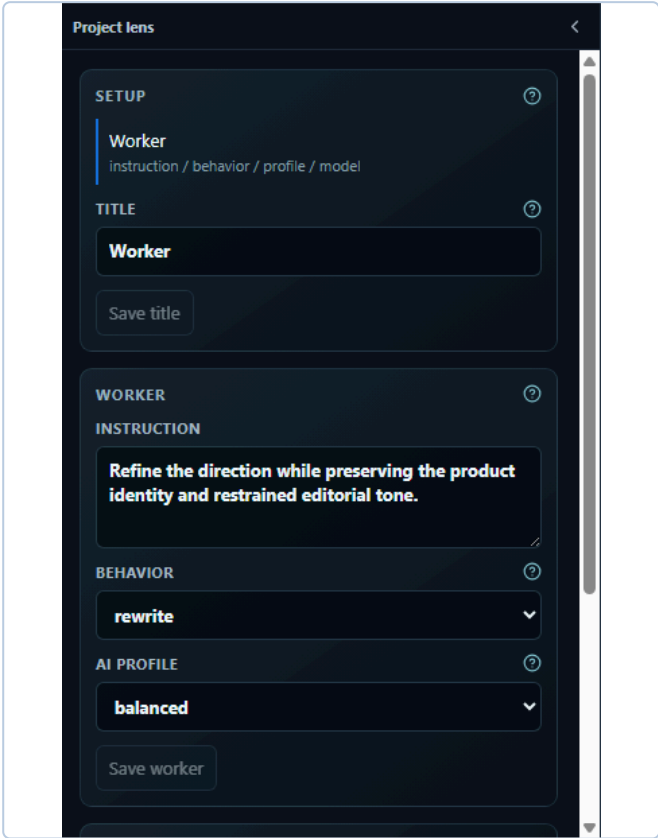
For errors and recovery steps, read [Ether 4.0 Troubleshooting](#). For release scope and known capability conditions, read [Ether 4.0 Release Notes](#).

# Inspector atlas

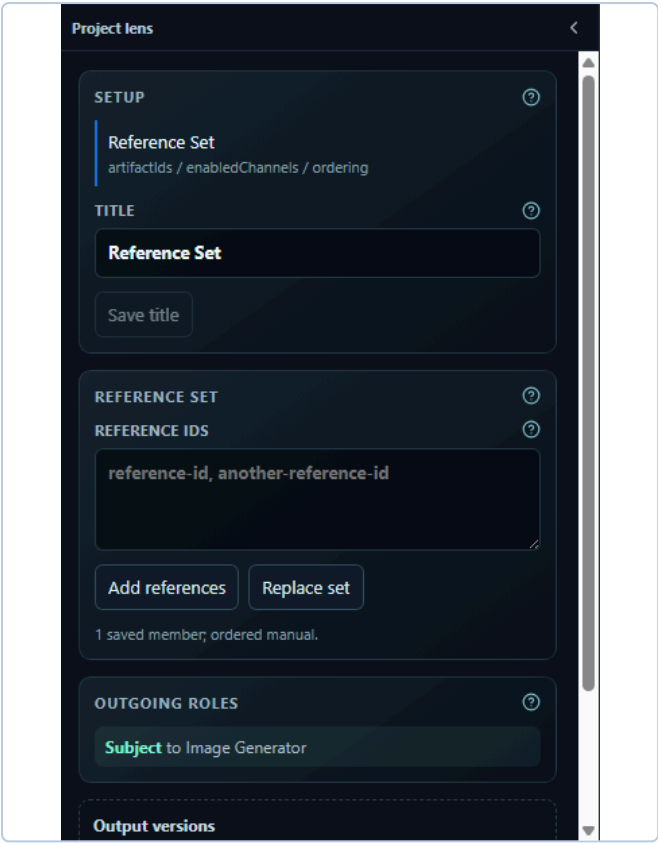
These installed-release captures show the ordinary controls for every canonical node. Advanced sections stay subordinate to each node's primary setup and action controls.



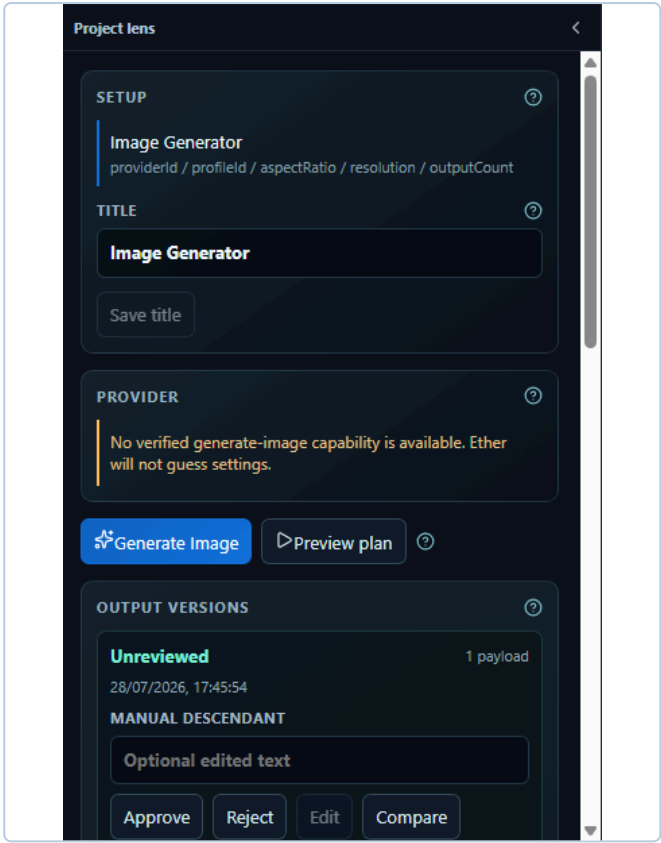
Packaged Ether release capture - Prompt Inspector



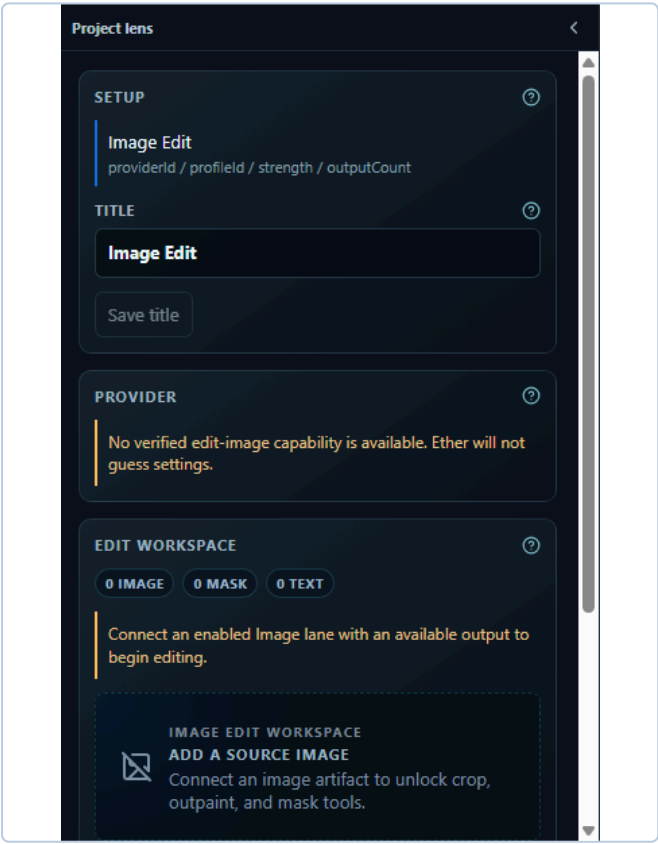
Packaged Ether release capture - LLM Worker Inspector



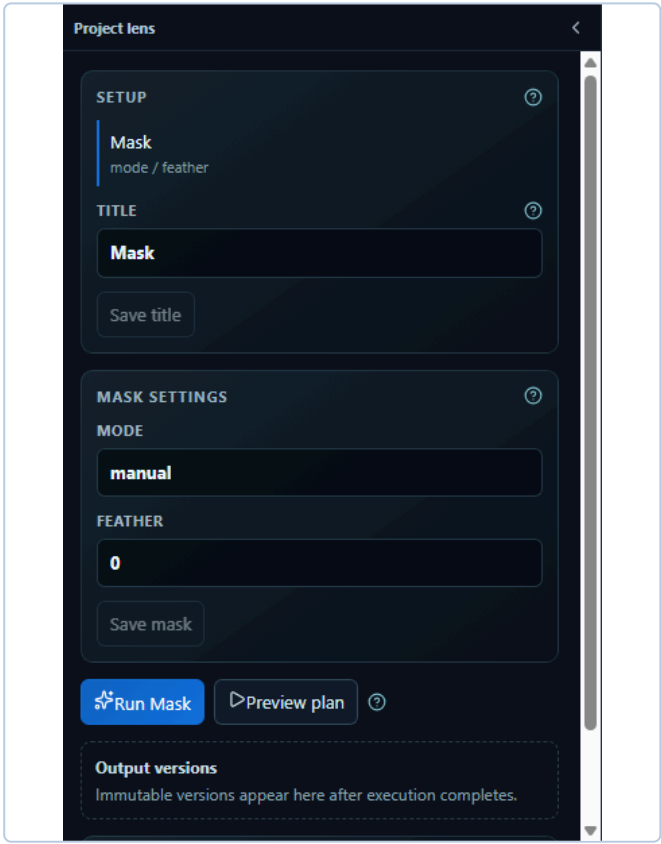
Packaged Ether release capture - Reference Set Inspector



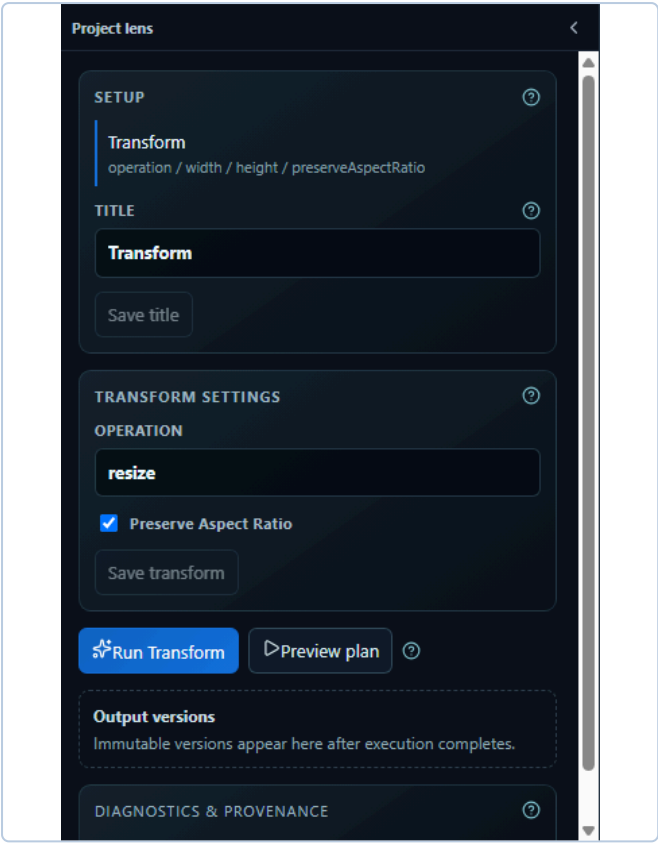
Packaged Ether release capture - Image Generator Inspector



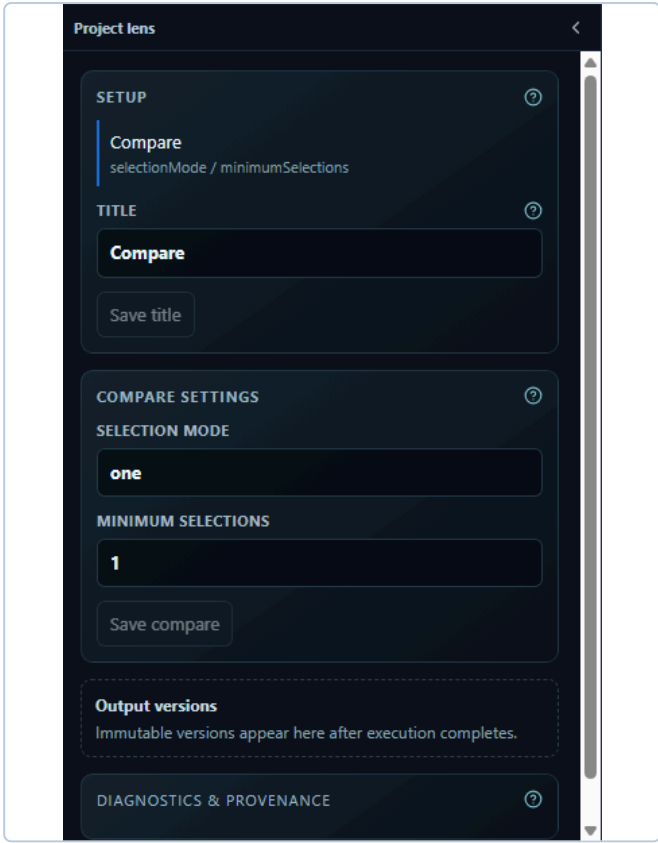
Packaged Ether release capture - Image Edit Inspector



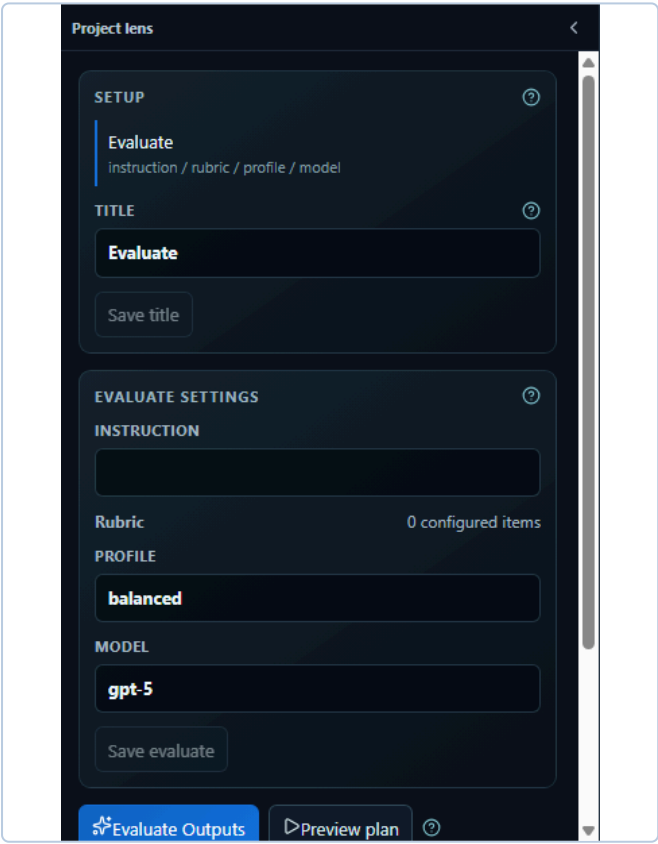
Packaged Ether release capture - Mask Inspector



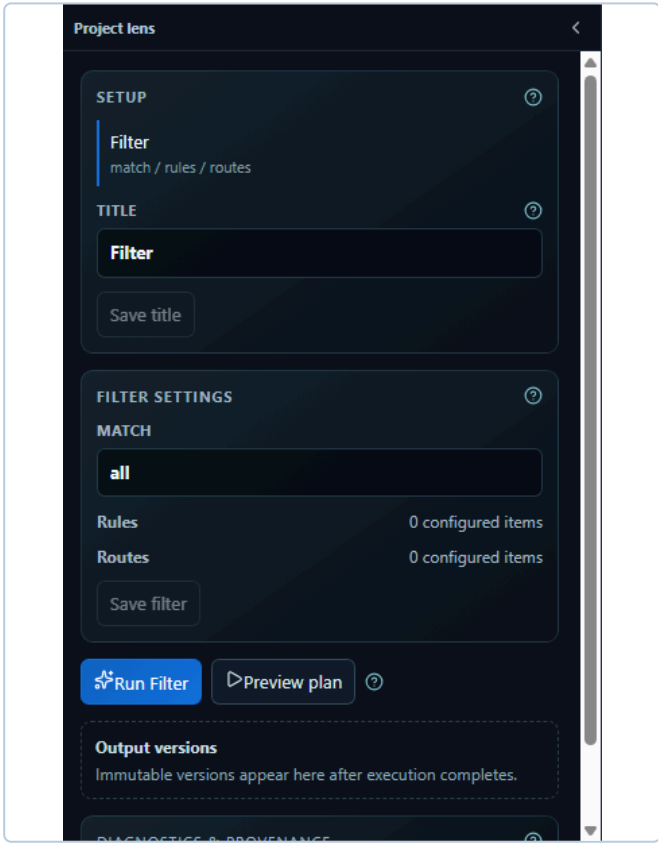
Packaged Ether release capture - Transform Inspector



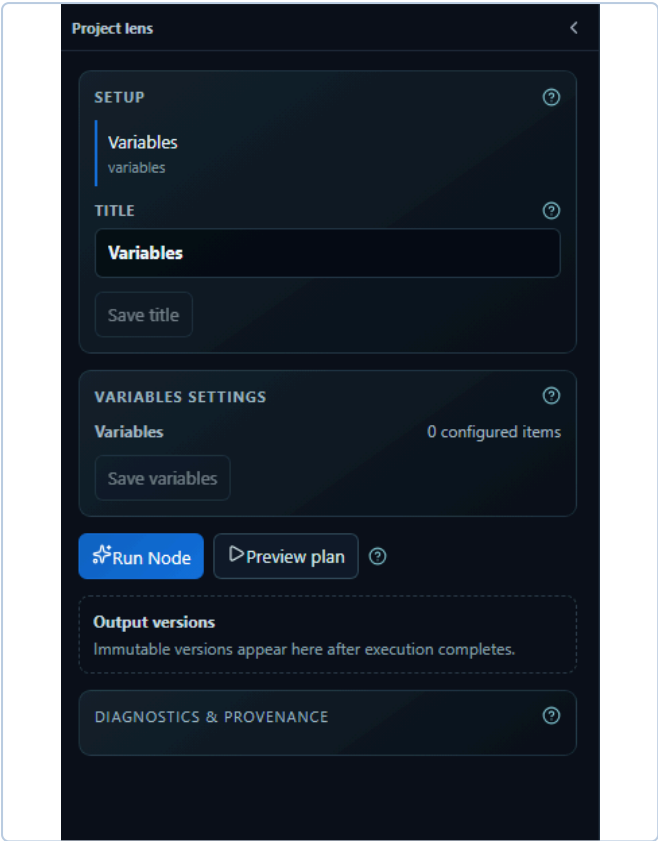
Packaged Ether release capture - Compare Inspector



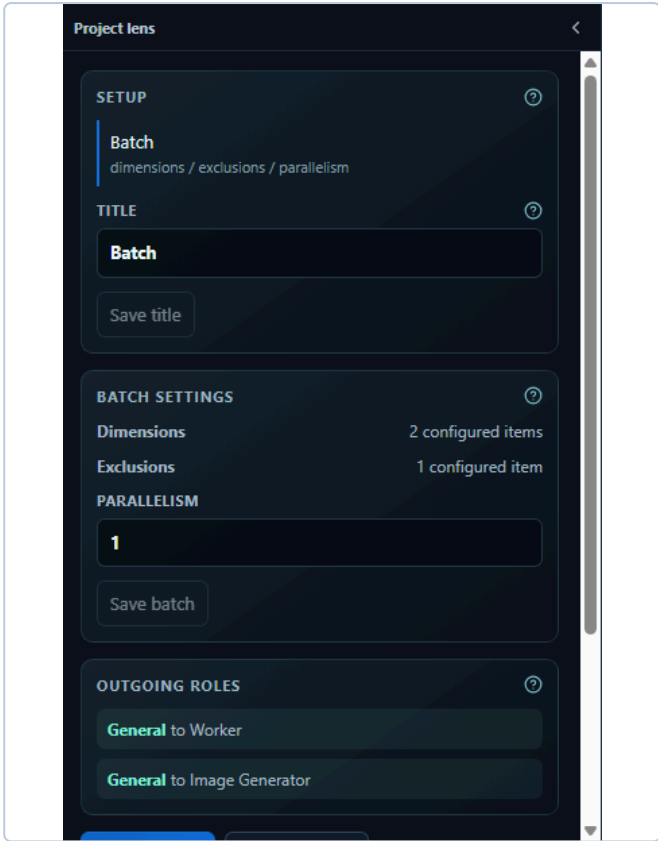
Packaged Ether release capture - Evaluate Inspector



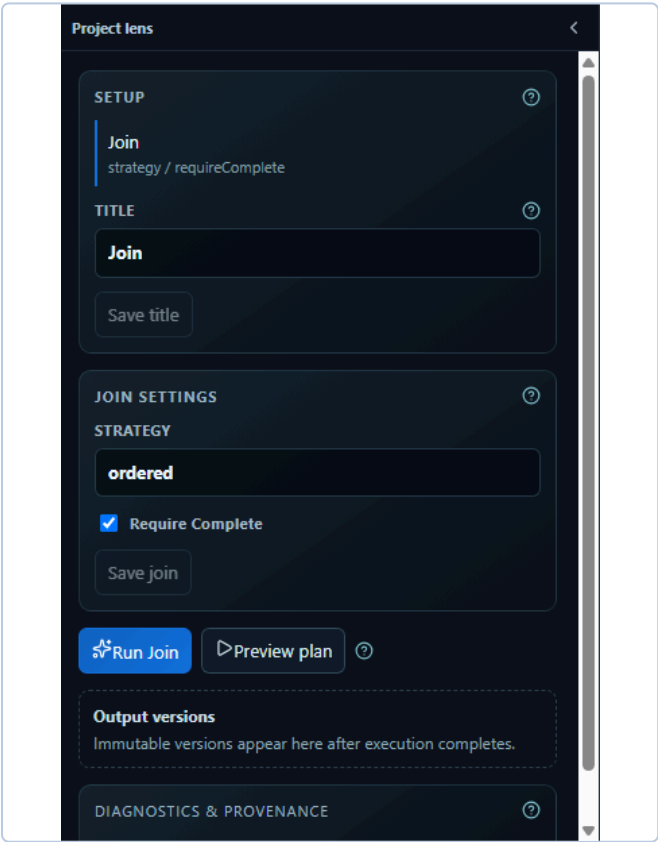
Packaged Ether release capture - Filter Inspector



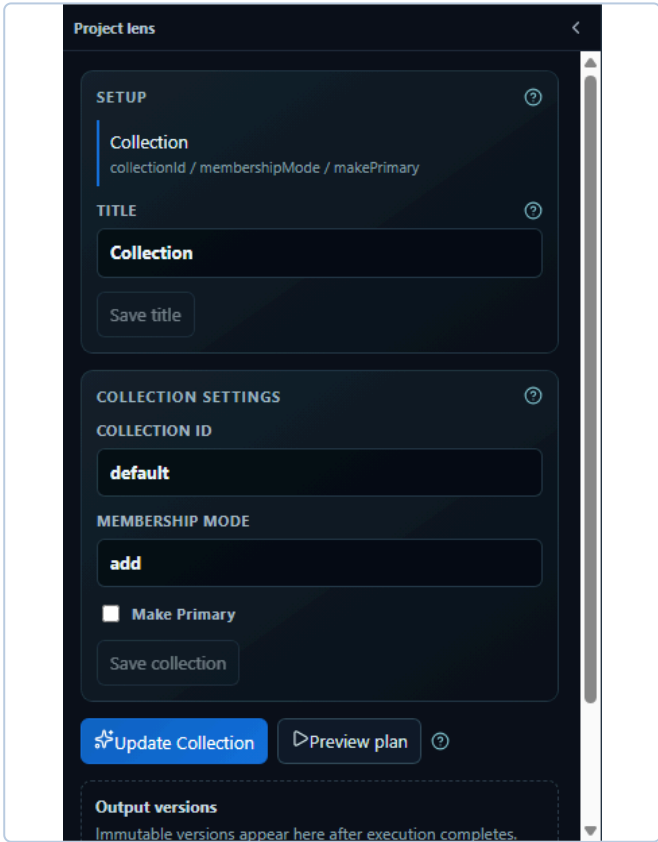
Packaged Ether release capture - Variables Inspector



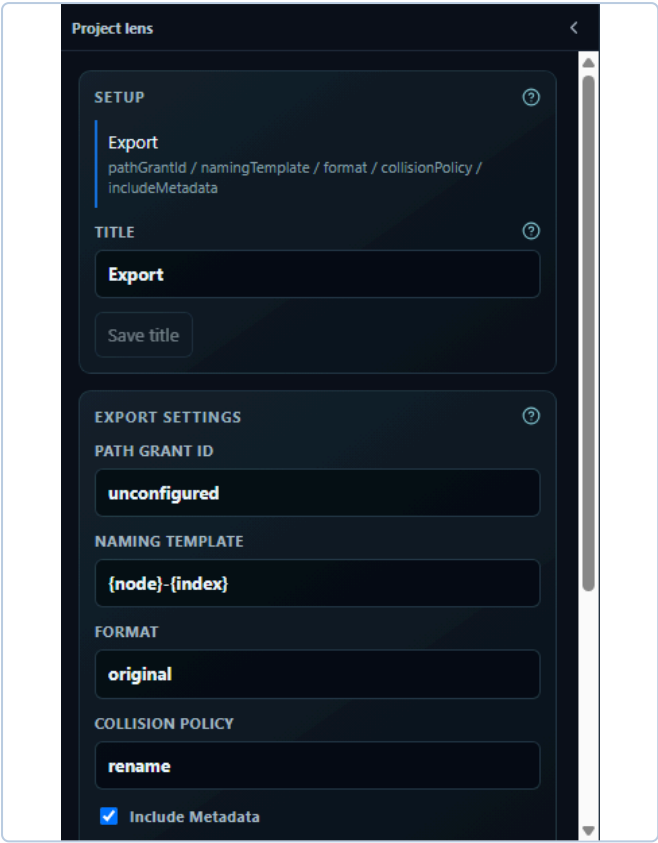
Packaged Ether release capture - Batch Inspector



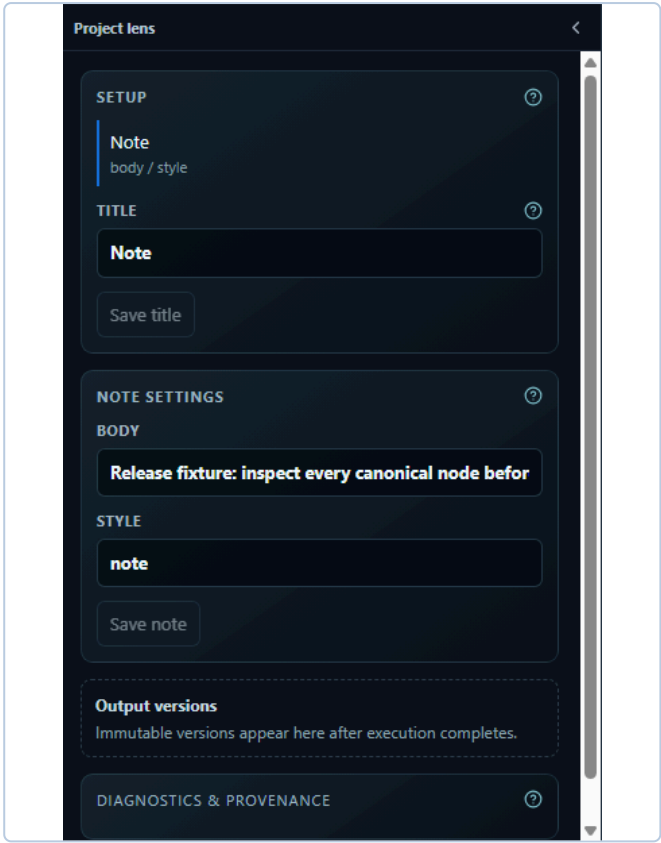
Packaged Ether release capture - Join Inspector



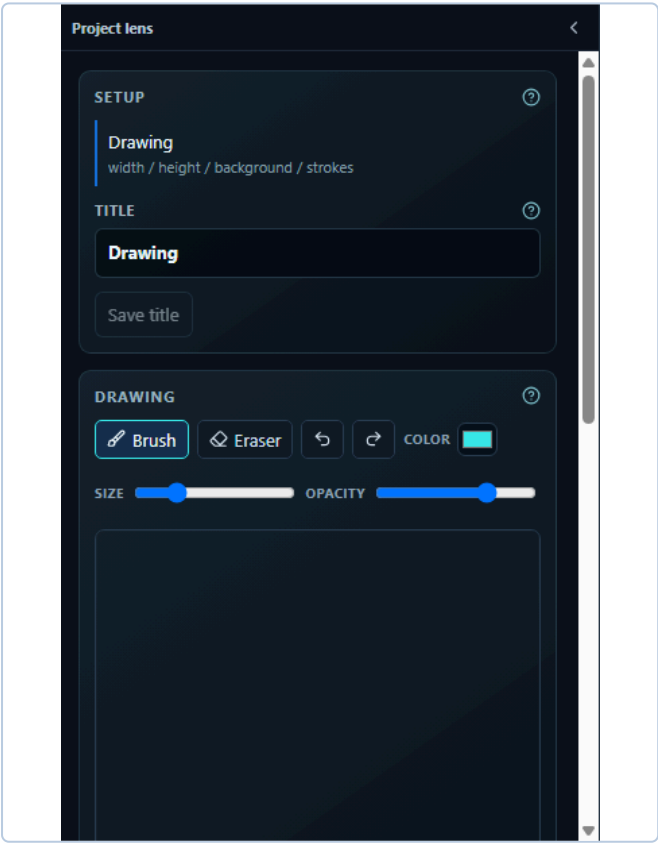
Packaged Ether release capture - Collection Inspector



Packaged Ether release capture - Export Inspector



Packaged Ether release capture - Note Inspector



Packaged Ether release capture - Drawing Inspector